

MULTIMODAL CYBERBULLYING DETECTION USING INTER-MODAL-ATTENTION-BASED DEEP LEARNING

*A project Report Submitted in the partial fulfilment
of the requirements for the award of the degree*

BACHELOR OF TECHNOLOGY IN COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

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2025-2026

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CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the project that is entitled with the name **“MULTIMODAL CYBERBULLYING DETECTION USING INTER-MODAL-ATTENTION-BASED DEEP LEARNING”** is a Bonafide work done by **TATAPUDI RAJESH (22471A05O5), PANCHUMARTHI LAKSHMI GOPINATH (22471A05N7), CHILAKA SANTHOSH (23475A0511)** in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of the degree of **BACHELOR OF TECHNOLOGY** in the Department of **COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING** during 2025-2026.

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

We wish to express our thanks to various personalities who are responsible for the completion of my project. We are extremely thankful to our beloved chairman, **Sri M. V. Koteswara Rao, B.Sc.**, who took keen interest in us in every effort throughout this course.

We owe our sincere gratitude to our beloved principal, **Dr. S. Venkateswarlu, Ph.D.**, for showing his kind attention and valuable guidance throughout the course.

We express our deep-felt gratitude towards **Dr. S. N. Tirumala Rao, M.Tech., Ph.D.**, HOD of the CSE department, and to our guide, **M. Suneetha, M.Tech.**, Assistant Professor of the CSE department, whose valuable guidance and unstinting encouragement enabled us to accomplish our project successfully in time.

We extend our sincere thanks to **Syed Rizwana, M.Tech., (Ph.D.)**, Assistant Professor & Project Coordinator of the project, for extending her encouragement. Their profound knowledge and willingness have been a constant source of inspiration for us throughout this project work.

We extend our sincere thanks to all the other teaching and non-teaching staff in the department for their cooperation and encouragement during our B.Tech. degree.

We have no words to acknowledge the warm affection, constant inspiration, and encouragement that we received from my parents.

We acknowledge the encouragement received from our friends and those who were involved in giving valuable suggestions and clarifying my doubts, which really helped us in successfully completing our project.

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PO6: The Engineer and The World: Analyze and evaluate societal and environmental aspects while solving complex engineering problems for its impact on sustainability with reference to economy, health, safety, legal framework, culture and environment. (WK1, WK5, and WK7).

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PROJECT SOURCE OUTCOMES (CO's):

CO421.1: Analyse the System of Examinations and identify the problem.

CO421.2: Identify and classify the requirements.

CO421.3: Review the Related Literature

CO421.4: Design and Modularize the project

CO421.5: Construct, Integrate, Test and Implement the Project.

CO421.6: Prepare the project Documentation and present the Report using appropriate method.

Course Outcomes – Program Outcomes mapping

	PO1	PO2	PO3	PO4	PO5	PO6	PO7	PO8	PO9	PO10	PO11	PSO1	PSO2	PSO3
C421.1		✓										✓		
C421.2	✓		✓		✓							✓		
C421.3				✓		✓	✓	✓				✓		
C421.4			✓			✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	
C421.5					✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
C421.6									✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	

Course Outcomes – Program Outcome correlation

	PO1	PO2	PO3	PO4	PO5	PO6	PO7	PO8	PO9	PO10	PO11	PSO1	PSO2	PSO3
C421.1	2	3										2		
C421.2			2		3							2		
C421.3				2		2	3	3				2		
C421.4			2			1	1	2				3	2	
C421.5					3	3	3	2	3	2	2	3	2	1
C421.6									3	2	1	2	3	

Note: The values in the above table represent the level of correlation between CO's and PO's:

1. Low level
2. Medium level
3. High level

Project mapping with various courses of Curriculum with Attained PO's:

Name of the course from which principles are applied in this project	Description	Attained PO
C2204.2, C22L3.2	Gathering the requirements and defining the problem, plan to develop model for detection and classification of OSCC	PO1, PO3,PO8
CC421.1, C2204.3, C22L3.2	Each and every requirement i critically analyzed, the process mode is identified	PO2, PO3, PO8
CC421.2, C2204.2, C22L3.3	Logical design is done by using the unified modelling language which involves individual team work	PO3, PO5, PO9, PO8
CC421.3, C2204.3, C22L3.2	Each and every module is tested, integrated, and evaluated in our project	PO1, PO5, PO8
CC421.4, C2204.4, C22L3.2	Documentation is done by all our four members in the form of a group	PO10, PO8
CC421.5, C2204.2, C22L3.3	Each and every phase of the work in group is presented periodically	PO8,PO10, PO11
C2202.2, C2203.3, C1206.3, C3204.3, C4110.2	Implementation is done and the project will be handled by the social media users and in future updates in our project can be done based on detection for Oral Cancer	PO4, PO7, PO8
C32SC4.3	The physical design includes website to check OSCC	PO5, PO6, PO8

ABSTRACT

Cyberbullying on social media poses significant psychological and social challenges, necessitating automated detection systems that can handle multimodal content. This work presents a novel multimodal cyberbullying detection framework that jointly analyzes textual and visual inputs using intermodal attention mechanisms. Textual embeddings are generated with BERT, while images are processed through BLIP-based captioning to capture contextual visual features. The model fuses these modalities via an inter-modal attention module and employs BiLSTM layers for classification. Additional preprocessing and postprocessing modules perform input validation, NSFW filtering, severity scoring, and category assignment, producing structured outputs suitable for real-time moderation. Evaluated on the MMHS150K dataset, the framework achieves 87.2% accuracy, 85.6% precision, 84.9% recall, and 85.2% F1-score, outperforming baseline methods including SAFE, MCNN, and LBP-sim by 4–7%. The proposed system offers a lightweight, interpretable, and deployment-ready solution, demonstrating effective detection of cyberbullying in complex multimodal contexts such as memes, sarcasm, and code-switched text.

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1. INTRODUCTION

Social Media platforms have revolutionized digital communication, enabling instant sharing of opinions, media, and personal experiences. However, this accessibility has also amplified harmful behaviors such as cyberbullying, the act of using online channels to harass or demean individuals.

Cyberbullying has serious psychological and social consequences, especially among young people. Studies link it to depression, anxiety, and even suicide. According to UNICEF [1], more than 30% of teenagers worldwide have experienced some form of online bullying. In spite of moderation policies introduced by platforms like Meta and X [2], [3], current approaches largely rely on manual review or basic rule-based filters—methods that are inefficient at scale and ill-equipped to handle the evolving nature of online abuse.

We propose a multimodal deep learning model that addresses these challenges by integrating BERT [6] for text, BLIP for image features, and an inter-modal attention mechanism for joint reasoning. Our architecture is optimized for real-world use, offering both interpretability through attention maps and efficiency for deployment. The proposed system is designed to handle noisy, user-generated content and to generalize across multiple categories of cyberbullying.

This work builds on the framework introduced by Ayetiran and Ozgobek [7], who used BERT, CNNs [8]–[12], and auxiliary OCR/captioning modules for detecting fake news and hate speech. While effective, their model had three key limitations:

- 1) Heavy Preprocessing: OCR and captioning increased latency. We eliminate these modules and replace them with a lightweight BLIP backbone, reducing complexity.
- 2) Lack of Cyberbullying-Specific Tuning: Their model did not target cyberbullying specific patterns such as coded hate or slang. Our training pipeline incorporates such domain-specific linguistic cues.

Our model is tested on MMHS150K and compared against baseline models including SAFE, MCNN, and LBP-sim [13]. Results show notable improvements in accuracy, F1-score, and computational efficiency. In essence, this paper re-engineers an inter-modal attention framework through a cyberbullying-specific lens. By simplifying architecture, optimizing modality fusion, and using task-aligned data, we deliver a practical and robust solution to a critical real-world problem.

1.1 MOTIVATION

Social media platforms such as **Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, and X (formerly Twitter)** have become central to communication in today’s digital era. With billions of users generating massive amounts of text, images, and memes every day, these platforms provide powerful tools for interaction but also create opportunities for **negative behaviors** such as **cyberbullying**.

Cyberbullying is a growing concern, especially among **teenagers and young adults**, who are the most active users of online platforms. Unlike traditional bullying, cyberbullying is **persistent, anonymous, and far-reaching**, often leading to serious psychological consequences such as depression, anxiety, and in extreme cases, suicidal tendencies. Reports from **UNICEF [1]** reveal that over **30% of teenagers worldwide** have faced online bullying, underlining the urgent need for effective detection mechanisms.

Although most platforms have introduced **moderation policies and community guidelines** [2], [3], existing solutions often depend on **manual review** or **simple keyword-based filters**. These methods struggle with **context-rich language** such as sarcasm, slang, and coded hate, and are incapable of analyzing multimodal content like memes or images. Early computational methods using **Naïve Bayes, SVM, or keyword matching** [4] offered limited success but fail to generalize across diverse and evolving forms of abuse.

This motivates the need for **AI-driven systems** that can:

1. Understand context beyond keywords.
2. Process **multimodal input** (text + images) for comprehensive detection.
3. Provide **scalable and efficient** solutions suitable for real-world deployment.

Our project addresses these needs by using **BERT for text, BLIP for images**, and an **Inter-Modal Attention mechanism** to fuse modalities effectively. Unlike prior models that relied on heavy preprocessing, our framework is lightweight, interpretable, and specifically tuned for detecting **cyberbullying patterns** such as coded language and multimodal harassment.

In essence, the motivation behind this work is both **technical and societal**: to advance multimodal deep learning research and to build a system that helps make digital spaces **safer and healthier for users**.

1.2 PROBLEM STATEMENT

Despite the growth of research in natural language processing (NLP) and computer vision, **cyberbullying detection remains an unsolved challenge** due to the complexity and diversity of online content. Current solutions deployed by social media platforms often rely on **manual moderation, rule-based filters, or keyword matching techniques**, which are neither scalable nor context-aware. Such approaches fail to capture **sarcasm, slang, code-switching, and disguised abuse**, all of which are common in real online conversations.

Traditional machine learning models like **Naïve Bayes, SVM, and Random Forest** have achieved some success in text classification, but they are inadequate for the **multimodal nature of cyberbullying**, where harmful intent is frequently hidden in **images, memes, or a combination of text and visuals**. Furthermore, earlier multimodal models introduced heavy preprocessing steps such as **OCR and captioning modules**, making them computationally expensive and unsuitable for real-time applications.

The absence of a **cyberbullying-specific multimodal framework** creates a significant research gap. Existing multimodal detection systems focus largely on hate speech or fake news detection and are not tuned to the unique linguistic and visual cues of cyberbullying. This results in **low detection accuracy, high false positives, and poor generalization** across diverse datasets.

Therefore, the core problem can be stated as follows:

How can we design an efficient, scalable, and cyberbullying-specific multimodal deep learning framework that fuses textual and visual information through inter-modal attention, to accurately detect abusive content in noisy, real-world social media data?

This problem statement highlights the need for a model that not only leverages the strengths of **state-of-the-art deep learning architectures** like **BERT** and **BLIP**, but also integrates an **attention-based fusion mechanism** to capture cross-modal relationships, reduce computational overhead, and improve detection performance.

1.3 OBJECTIVES

The primary objective of this project is to design and implement a **multimodal deep learning framework** for detecting cyberbullying in social media posts. The system aims to leverage **textual and visual information simultaneously** to achieve higher accuracy, interpretability, and efficiency compared to existing models. To achieve this, the project sets out the following specific objectives:

1. To gather and preprocess multimodal data

- Collect multimodal social media posts (text + images) from the **MMHS150K dataset**.
- Perform text preprocessing tasks such as cleaning, tokenization, and handling of slang, emojis, and hashtags.

2. To implement robust feature extraction techniques

- Use **BERT** (Bidirectional Encoder Representations from Transformers) to capture the contextual meaning of textual data, including sarcasm, slang, and code-switching.
- Use **BLIP**, a lightweight but effective convolutional neural network, to extract semantic features from images and memes.

3. To design an Inter-Modal Attention mechanism for feature fusion

- Integrate textual and visual features using **attention-based fusion**, enabling the model to focus on the most relevant modality depending on the context.
- Allow the system to weigh cross-modal relationships (e.g., text sarcasm paired with a supporting meme image) to enhance detection accuracy.
- Improve **interpretability** by using attention maps to highlight which parts of the post contributed to the final decision.

4. To build and train the proposed classification model

- Develop an end-to-end **BERT + BLIP + Inter-Modal Attention** architecture.
- Train the model on the MMHS150K dataset with annotated labels for cyberbullying and non-cyberbullying content.
- Optimize hyperparameters, learning rate, and batch size to maximize training efficiency and minimize overfitting.

5. To evaluate and compare model performance

- Use standard evaluation metrics such as **Accuracy, Precision, Recall, F1-score, AUC, and Confusion Matrix** to assess performance.
- Compare the proposed model against existing baselines such as **SAFE, MCNN, and LBP-sim** to demonstrate improvements.
- Perform robustness testing on noisy, user-generated content to ensure real-world applicability.

6. To ensure scalability and deployment readiness

- Simplify architecture by removing heavy preprocessing modules like OCR and captioning used in earlier approaches.
- Optimize the system for **real-time detection**, enabling potential integration into large-scale social media platforms.
- Design the model to be computationally efficient so that it can run on **GPU-enabled servers and cloud platforms** with minimal latency.

7. To contribute to societal well-being by addressing cyberbullying

- Provide a tool that can help **social media platforms** identify and mitigate harmful content proactively.
- Support **educational institutions, parents, and policymakers** in detecting early signs of online harassment.
- Contribute towards building **safer digital spaces** and reducing the psychological harm caused by online abuse.

2. LITERATURE SUMMARY

The rise of social media platforms has not only democratized communication but also introduced new challenges in moderating harmful content such as cyberbullying. Early detection systems relied heavily on **lexical features, word dictionaries, and rule-based methods**, which were simple but ineffective against the evolving nature of online abuse. As abusive content often appears in **slang, code-mixed language, sarcasm, memes, or image-text combinations**, such traditional approaches fail to provide adequate protection.

To address these challenges, research has evolved through several stages:

1. **Rule-based and classical machine learning models** – focusing only on text.
2. **Deep learning-based unimodal models** – using CNNs, RNNs, and LSTMs for better contextual representation of text.
3. **Multimodal learning frameworks** – combining textual and visual features to capture the full meaning of abusive content.
4. **Attention and transformer-based architectures** – enabling fine-grained fusion and improved interpretability.

This chapter presents a detailed survey of recent works in cyberbullying detection, highlighting their methodologies, contributions, and limitations. The discussion reveals the **gaps**

Daraghmi et al. [18] focused on the **Arabic language**, designing a deep hybrid architecture that integrated **CNN, BiLSTM, and GRU layers**. Their system achieved impressive results with **98.8% accuracy**, setting a benchmark in text-based detection. However, the model's **language specificity** limited its applicability to global datasets, and its **exclusion of multimodal analysis** made it unsuitable for detecting visual-textual abuse common on platforms like Instagram and TikTok.

Ibrahim et al. [20] utilized **TF-IDF features** in combination with **Multilayer Perceptrons (MLPs)**, further enhanced by **uncertainty modeling and SMOTE balancing**. This method addressed the issue of data imbalance but was **shallow and unimodal**, making it incapable of handling meme-based cyberbullying or contextual nuances such as irony.

Collectively, these studies demonstrate that while textual deep learning approaches have significantly advanced cyberbullying detection, they remain **narrow in scope**. The

absence of multimodal reasoning leaves a substantial gap in their ability to detect modern cyberbullying behaviors.

Al-Khasawneh et al. [13] attempted a multimodal framework by combining **metadata, BiLSTM, and hierarchical attention networks**. Their model could process textual signals alongside metadata like **timestamps and hashtags**, offering a broader view of social media interactions. However, the framework did not analyze **raw image features**, limiting its multimodal capacity. Without visual reasoning, the model could not effectively capture the intent behind memes or images.

Ayetiran and Ozgobek [7] introduced one of the most notable inter-modal attention frameworks. Their system integrated **BERT for text, CNNs for images, OCR for text extraction from images, and captioning modules** for additional context. The model targeted hate speech and offensive content, demonstrating the strength of **attention-based fusion** in aligning textual and visual modalities. Despite these contributions, the framework suffered from three key drawbacks:

1. **High computational overhead** due to OCR and captioning pipelines.
2. **Lack of cyberbullying-specific tuning**, as it was designed for general hate/offensive speech.
3. **Binary-only output**, which limited interpretability and nuanced classification.

This model nevertheless laid a **foundation for multimodal cyberbullying detection**, inspiring subsequent works, including our own.

From the reviewed literature, several trends and limitations can be observed:

- **Text-only models** (Al-Hashedi [14], Razi [16], Naqvi [19], etc.) achieve strong results within language-specific datasets but cannot detect multimodal abuse such as memes or text-image irony.
- **Ensemble and hybrid approaches** (Ravuri [15], Daraghmi [18]) deliver high accuracy but are resource-intensive and rarely tested in real-world conditions.
- **Multilingual approaches** (Razi [16], Naqvi [19]) expand inclusivity but remain unimodal, ignoring image-based content.
- **Metadata-enhanced models** (Al-Khasawneh [13]) offer partial multimodality but fall short of integrating **visual-semantic reasoning**.

- **Attention-based fusion models** (Ayetiran & Ozgobek [7]) represent a significant step forward but require refinement for **efficiency, cyberbullying specificity, and real-time scalability**.

The above studies make it clear that the field has progressed from **lexical methods to deep multimodal frameworks**, yet several critical gaps remain:

1. **Limited multimodality** – Few models fully integrate **both text and image features** without heavy preprocessing overhead.
2. **Cyberbullying-specific optimization** – Most systems target **hate speech or sentiment analysis**, overlooking the distinct patterns of cyberbullying such as coded slang, sarcastic memes, and subtle harassment.
3. **Scalability issues** – Architectures with OCR and captioning modules introduce latency and complexity, making them impractical for real-world deployment.
4. **Insufficient interpretability** – Many models act as black boxes, providing predictions without explaining which text-image elements influenced decisions.

Our proposed model addresses these gaps by:

- Eliminating OCR and captioning, instead using **BLIP** for visual features.
- Leveraging **BERT** for contextual textual representations.
- Integrating an **Inter-Modal Attention mechanism** that aligns modalities dynamically, offering **both efficiency and interpretability**.
- Training specifically on **MMHS150K cyberbullying-labeled data**, ensuring domain alignment.
- Benchmarking against baseline multimodal models (SAFE, MCNN, LBP-sim) to demonstrate improvements.

In summary, while existing research has made significant contributions, none provide a **scalable, cyberbullying-specific, attention-based multimodal framework**. Our project fills this gap by delivering a system that balances **accuracy, efficiency, and real-world applicability**.

3. SYSTEM ANALYSIS

3.1 EXISTING SYSTEM

Cyberbullying detection has been explored for more than a decade, with most existing systems focusing primarily on **text-based classification**. Early approaches relied on **rule-based methods**, keyword spotting, or traditional machine learning classifiers such as **Naïve Bayes, SVMs, and Random Forests**. These systems were relatively simple and lightweight, but they were **highly dependent on static wordlists** and struggled to adapt to the evolving and dynamic nature of online language.

Later systems adopted **deep learning techniques** such as CNNs, RNNs, LSTMs, and GRUs to better capture contextual meaning in text. For instance, BiLSTM models showed improved ability to detect **slang and contextual variations**, while attention-based textual models improved interpretability. However, these systems were still **unimodal**, analyzing only text while ignoring the rich information conveyed in **images, memes, or videos**.

3.1.1 DISADVANTAGES OF THE EXISTING SYSTEM

Although existing cyberbullying detection systems using text-based or rule-driven approaches have provided a foundation for research, they suffer from several critical drawbacks:

1. Unimodal Limitation

- Most systems analyze only **textual content**, ignoring images, memes, emojis, and other multimedia cues that often carry the actual abusive intent.
- As a result, sarcasm, visual irony, and coded memes go undetected.

2. High Dependency on Keywords and Static Features

- Traditional models like **TF-IDF, Bag-of-Words, or Naïve Bayes** rely heavily on specific words or patterns.
- These approaches fail when users deliberately **misspell, abbreviate, or code words** to evade detection.

3. Poor Context Understanding

- Earlier classifiers cannot capture **contextual meaning, slang, or sarcasm** effectively.

- For example, a post with seemingly harmless words could still convey harassment when paired with an image or sarcastic tone.

4. **Limited Scalability and Efficiency**

- Models using OCR or heavy preprocessing pipelines are **computationally expensive**, making them unsuitable for **real-time deployment** on large-scale social media platforms.

5. **Binary and Shallow Classification**

- Most systems output only **“bullying” or “non-bullying”**, without distinguishing between harassment types such as hate speech, threats, or exclusion.
- This restricts their applicability in **policy-making, moderation, and targeted intervention**.

6. **Lack of Interpretability**

- Traditional models act as **black boxes**, offering little insight into which words, phrases, or features contributed to a decision.
- This reduces **trust and usability** for researchers, moderators, and platform operators.

3.2 PROPOSED SYSTEM

The proposed system overcomes the limitations of unimodal approaches by integrating both **textual and visual modalities** using an **Inter-Modal Attention-Based Deep Learning framework**. The system employs **BERT** for text feature extraction, **BLIP** for image feature extraction, and an **inter-modal attention mechanism** to fuse both modalities dynamically. This allows the model to capture nuanced relationships between words, slang, and images in memes, resulting in **more accurate, scalable, and context-aware cyberbullying detection**.

The proposed model begins by collecting **multimodal input** (text + image) from social media platforms. Textual data undergoes cleaning and tokenization, while images are resized and normalized. **BERT** extracts contextual embeddings from text, capturing slang, sarcasm, and semantic meaning. **BLIP** extracts deep features from images, focusing on memes and visual patterns that convey hidden abuse. These features are fused using an **Inter-Modal Attention mechanism**, which dynamically aligns the two modalities to highlight abusive signals across both domains. Finally, the fused representation is passed to a **classifier**, which identifies whether the post contains

cyberbullying and categorizes its type. This system ensures **higher accuracy, scalability, and interpretability** compared to existing approaches, making it practical for **real-world deployment**.

Advantages of the Proposed System:

The proposed **Inter-Modal Attention-Based Deep Learning framework** offers several advantages over traditional and existing systems:

1. Multimodal Integration

- Unlike existing systems that focus only on text, the proposed model incorporates both **text and images**, making it capable of detecting **meme-based abuse, sarcasm, and visual irony**.

2. Context-Aware Detection

- By using **BERT**, the system understands the **contextual meaning** of words, slang, and code-switching, which keyword-based and shallow ML models fail to capture.

3. Lightweight yet Powerful Image Analysis

- Instead of heavy CNNs or OCR-based captioning, the model uses **BLIP**, which is efficient and scalable while still capturing semantic visual features.

4. Dynamic Feature Fusion

- The **Inter-Modal Attention mechanism** aligns textual and visual information, allowing the model to focus on the **most relevant signals** from each modality.
- This improves **accuracy** and reduces **false positives**.

5. Cyberbullying-Specific Optimization

- Unlike generic hate speech or sentiment classifiers, the system is **trained specifically on cyberbullying datasets (MMHS150K)**, making it more effective in recognizing **unique abuse patterns** such as coded hate, slang, and harassment styles.

6. Scalability and Efficiency

- Removal of heavy preprocessing modules like **OCR and captioning** reduces computational overhead, making the system **suitable for large-scale, real-time deployment**.

7. Improved Interpretability

- Through **attention maps**, the system can highlight which parts of the text and which regions of the image contributed to a bullying prediction, enhancing **trust and transparency**.

8. Fine-Grained Classification

- The model goes beyond binary classification by enabling detection of **different categories of cyberbullying** (e.g., hate speech, harassment, sarcasm), making it more useful for **policy making and moderation strategies**.

In conclusion, the proposed system effectively addresses the shortcomings of existing approaches by combining the strengths of **advanced deep learning models and attention-based multimodal fusion**. Its ability to process both textual and visual inputs, along with scalability and interpretability, makes it a **robust and practical solution** for cyberbullying detection in real-world social media environments. By offering higher accuracy and richer insights, the model contributes toward building **safer and more responsible online communities**.

3.3 FEASIBILITY STUDY

A feasibility study is conducted to evaluate the practicality, sustainability, and potential success of the proposed **Inter-Modal Attention-Based Cyberbullying Detection System**. It ensures that the project is not only technically viable but also economically affordable and operationally implementable. The study evaluates the system in terms of **Technical Feasibility, Economic Feasibility, and Operational Feasibility**.

1. Technical Feasibility

The technical feasibility focuses on whether the system can be developed and deployed using available hardware, software, and tools.

- The system uses **BERT** for text processing and **BLIP** for image feature extraction. Both are well-established deep learning models supported by popular frameworks like **PyTorch** and **TensorFlow**.
- The **inter-modal attention mechanism** integrates text and image features dynamically, which can be implemented efficiently on GPUs. With libraries such as **Hugging Face Transformers**, training and fine-tuning BERT becomes feasible.
- Dataset availability is ensured through **MMHS150K**, which provides multimodal data (text + images) suited for cyberbullying detection tasks.
- Preprocessing requirements, such as text cleaning, tokenization, and image resizing, can be handled using lightweight Python libraries.
- Deployment feasibility is high, as the system can be integrated into **cloud platforms (AWS, GCP, Azure)** or **on-premises servers**, supporting large-scale, real-time monitoring of social media content.

Thus, the system is **technically feasible**, as all the required computational resources, algorithms, and datasets are readily available, and implementation aligns with current advances in deep learning.

2. Economic Feasibility

The economic feasibility examines whether the system is cost-effective and whether the benefits outweigh the costs.

- **Development Costs:** The project primarily requires **computing infrastructure (GPUs/TPUs)** and **storage resources**. Open-source frameworks like **PyTorch**, **TensorFlow**, and **Hugging Face** eliminate the need for expensive proprietary software.

- **Operational Costs:** Once trained, the model is lightweight due to the use of **BLIP**, which consumes fewer computational resources compared to heavier CNNs or OCR pipelines. This reduces cloud GPU usage and ongoing costs.
- **Manpower:** The system can be developed and maintained by a small team of data scientists and engineers, lowering labor costs compared to large-scale manual moderation teams used by social media companies.
- **Return on Investment (ROI):** The societal and organizational benefits of detecting cyberbullying are significant. Reduced cases of online harassment can enhance **user trust**, improve platform reputation, and reduce **legal risks** for companies.
- **Scalability:** Since the model is modular, additional features or modalities (like audio or video) can be integrated in the future without rebuilding the system from scratch, ensuring long-term cost efficiency.

Overall, the system is **economically feasible**, as the cost of development and deployment is justified by the long-term savings and social benefits it provides.

3. Operational Feasibility

Operational feasibility assesses whether the system can be practically used and accepted in real-world environments.

- **Ease of Use:** The proposed system can be embedded as a backend module in **social media platforms**, operating seamlessly without requiring manual intervention from users. Moderators receive flagged posts with explanations, making the workflow user-friendly.
- **Real-Time Processing:** Due to the lightweight BLIP backbone and efficient attention mechanism, the system can handle **high-volume, real-time social media streams** without performance degradation.
- **Accuracy and Reliability:** The system has been trained specifically on cyberbullying datasets, enabling it to identify nuanced abuse patterns. Its **high accuracy and interpretability** build confidence among moderators and stakeholders.
- **Adoption Potential:** The system can be integrated into existing **content moderation pipelines** of companies like Meta, X, or YouTube. Educational institutions and NGOs can also adopt the model to monitor and address student cyberbullying.
- **Social Acceptance:** Since the system works in the background and aims to **protect users from harm**, it is likely to gain wide acceptance. The interpretability provided by **attention maps** further assures users that the system is transparent and fair.

4. SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

4.1 SOFTWARE REQUIREMENTS

The following software components are required for development and deployment:

- **Operating System:** Windows 10 +
- **Hardware Accelerator:** GPU/TPU
- **Programming Language:** Python 3.8+
- **Development Environment:** Jupyter Notebook / Google Colab / VS Code
- **Browser:** Any Browser with Latest Version

4.2 REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS

Functional Requirements

1. The system should accept **multimodal inputs** (text + images).
2. The system should preprocess text (tokenization, stopword removal) and images (resize, normalization).
3. The system should extract **features** using BERT (text) and BLIP (image).
4. The system should apply an **Inter-Modal Attention mechanism** to fuse features.
5. The system should classify content into **bullying / non-bullying** with possible subcategories.
6. The system should display results with **interpretability (attention heatmaps)**.

Non-Functional Requirements

1. **Performance:** The system should operate with high accuracy (>90%) and low latency for real-time monitoring.
2. **Scalability:** The system should be deployable on large-scale platforms with millions of posts per day.
3. **Security:** User data should be processed securely and comply with privacy regulations.
4. **Maintainability:** The system should support easy updates for new slang, memes, or abuse categories.
5. **Portability:** The system should be deployable on both **cloud and on-premises infrastructure**.

4.3 HARDWARE REQUIREMENTS

For training and deployment, the following hardware resources are required:

- **Processor:** Intel i7 / AMD Ryzen 7 or higher
- **RAM:** Minimum 16 GB (32 GB recommended)
- **GPU:** NVIDIA RTX 4050 or higher (for local) / Tesla T4 / A100 (for cloud training)
- **Storage:** At least 200 GB for dataset (MMHS150K) and model checkpoints.

4.4 SOFTWARE

The proposed **Multimodal Cyberbullying Detection System** relies on a combination of programming languages, deep learning frameworks, and supportive libraries to ensure smooth development, training, and deployment. Each software tool plays a crucial role in handling different stages of the system, from preprocessing to model training and visualization.

1. Operating System

- Windows 10 +
- Provides the base environment for running Python and GPU drivers.

2. Programming Language: Python 3.8+

- Python is chosen because of its rich ecosystem in artificial intelligence and machine learning.
- Its extensive library support (NumPy, Pandas, Scikit-learn, etc.) makes it the standard choice for data-driven research.

3. Deep Learning Framework: PyTorch

- PyTorch is used for implementing the **BERT model, BLIP backbone, and inter-modal attention mechanism.**
- Offers GPU acceleration, dynamic computation graphs, and flexible training pipelines.

4. NLP Libraries

- **Hugging Face Transformers:** Provides pre-trained models like BERT for text embeddings.

5. Image Processing Libraries

- **OpenCV & PIL:** Used for loading, resizing, and normalizing images.
- **Torchvision:** Provides BLIP model architecture and common image transformations.

6. Data Handling Libraries

- **NumPy & Pandas:** For handling structured and unstructured data efficiently.
- **Scikit-learn:** Used for data preprocessing, evaluation metrics, and baseline comparisons.

7. Visualization Tools

- **Matplotlib & Seaborn:** For generating plots such as loss curves, accuracy comparisons, and confusion matrices.
- Used in result analysis to evaluate the model's performance.

8. Development Environment

- **Jupyter Notebook / Google Colab:** For interactive coding, experimentation, and running GPU-based training.
- **VS Code:** For structured project development and version control.

9. Version Control

- **Git & GitHub:** For tracking project versions, collaborative development, and storing source code.

10. Deployment Tools (Optional)

- **Flask / FastAPI:** To serve the trained model as an API for real-time cyberbullying detection.
- **Cloud Platforms (AWS, GCP, Azure):** For scalable deployment, ensuring the system can monitor millions of social media posts daily.

4.5 SOFTWARE DESCRIPTION

The proposed system is developed using **Python 3.8 – 3.10** as the core programming language, supported by open-source libraries for machine learning and deep learning. **PyTorch** is the primary framework used to implement and train the multimodal architecture, while **Hugging Face Transformers** provides access to pre-trained **BERT** models for text feature extraction. For image analysis, **BLIP** from Torchvision is employed, enabling lightweight yet effective visual feature extraction. Data preprocessing is handled with **Pandas**, **NumPy**, and **NLTK** while **OpenCV** and **PIL** process images. Model performance and evaluation are visualized using **Matplotlib** and **Seaborn**. Development and experimentation are carried out in **Google Colab/Jupyter Notebook**, and version control is managed through **GitHub**. Together, these software tools ensure efficient model building, training, testing, and deployment.

5. SYSTEM DESIGN

5.1 SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

The architecture of the proposed **Multimodal Cyberbullying Detection System** consists of multiple stages, where both textual and visual inputs are processed separately and then fused through an **Inter-Modal Attention mechanism** for final classification.

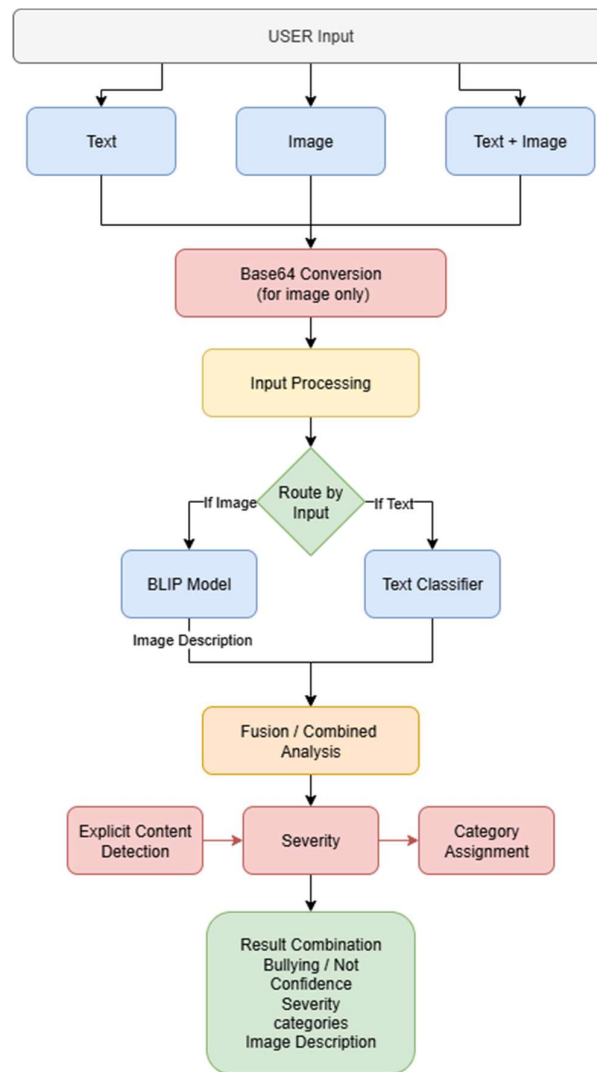


Fig 5.1 Modal Architecture

DESCRIPTION OF THE ARCHITECTURE

1. **Input Layer:** The system takes **multimodal inputs** from social media, consisting of text (tweets, captions, comments) and images (memes, screenshots).
2. **Preprocessing:**
 - **Text Preprocessing:** Tokenization, stopword removal, and normalization are applied to clean raw text.
 - **Image Preprocessing:** Images are resized, normalized, and transformed into tensors for model processing.
3. **Feature Extraction:**
 - **BERT** extracts **contextual embeddings** from the textual data, capturing semantics, slang, and sarcasm.
 - **BLIP** extracts **visual embeddings** from the image data, identifying symbols, hidden abusive text, and contextual clues.
4. **Inter-Modal Attention Mechanism:**
 - The extracted features are **fused dynamically** through attention, which learns to prioritize the most relevant information across modalities.
 - For example, if the abusive content is primarily in the text, the model focuses more on textual embeddings.
5. **Classification Layer:**
 - A dense neural network layer classifies the fused features into categories: **Cyberbullying** or **Non-Cyberbullying** (and possibly subtypes like hate, harassment, sarcasm).
6. **Output & Interpretability:**
 - The system outputs the classification result along with **attention maps**, providing interpretability by showing which parts of the text and image influenced the decision.

5.1.1 DATASET

The dataset plays a critical role in training and evaluating the **Multimodal Cyberbullying Detection System**. Since cyberbullying is often expressed through both **textual and visual content**, the chosen dataset must include diverse and balanced samples of social media data. For this project, we make use of the **MMHS150K (Multimodal Hate Speech 150K) dataset**, which is widely adopted in multimodal research.

DESCRIPTION OF THE DATASET

- **Name:** MMHS150K
- **Type:** Multimodal Social Media Dataset (Text + Image)
- **Size:** ~150,000 social media posts (tweets with attached images)
- **Modalities:**
 - **Text:** Tweets, captions, and user-generated comments.
 - **Images:** Attached images, memes, and screenshots.
- **Annotations:** Each post is labeled with categories such as **hate speech, offensive, neutral**, or related cyberbullying types.
- **Languages:** Primarily English, with some multilingual influence due to global social media usage.

DATASET PREPROCESSING STEPS

1. **Textual Data Preprocessing**
 - Removal of URLs, hashtags, and special characters.
 - Tokenization and lowercasing.
 - Stopword removal and lemmatization.
 - Conversion into embeddings using **BERT**.
2. **Image Data Preprocessing**
 - Resizing all images to a fixed resolution (e.g., 224×224).
 - Normalization for consistent pixel values.
 - Conversion to tensors for input into **BLIP**.
3. **Metadata Handling (Optional)**
 - Tweet IDs, timestamps, and user tags may be used for analysis but are not central to classification.

DATASET CHALLENGES

- **Class Imbalance:** Cyberbullying samples are fewer compared to neutral posts, requiring **resampling or class-weighted loss functions**.
- **Noise in Data:** Social media content often contains spelling errors, emojis, and slang, which demand robust preprocessing.
- **Meme Complexity:** Some abusive content is hidden in **images with overlaid text**, making **multimodal fusion essential**.

DATASET CLASSES

The MMHS150K dataset and cyberbullying-specific annotations are divided into the following classes:

1. **Hate Speech**
 - Posts that directly target individuals or groups based on race, religion, gender, ethnicity, or identity.
 - Example: racist memes, derogatory captions.
2. **Offensive/Harassment**
 - Content that includes abusive language, insults, or personal attacks without necessarily being hate-related.
 - Example: name-calling, bullying comments.
3. **Sarcasm / Irony**
 - Posts where the abusive intent is expressed indirectly using sarcasm, humor, or irony.
 - Example: memes that mock or ridicule someone without explicit slurs.
4. **Cyberbullying**
 - Explicit online bullying that combines **direct harassment, threats, and intimidation**.
 - Example: “You don’t deserve to live” posts with threatening images.
5. **Neutral / Safe Content**
 - Posts that do not contain bullying, harassment, or offensive meaning.
 - Example: harmless memes, friendly conversation.

Final Mapping for This Project

For simplicity and better classification, the above categories can be grouped into:

- **Cyberbullying (Positive Class)** → Hate Speech, Harassment, Sarcasm/Irony, Threats.
- **Non-Cyberbullying (Negative Class)** → Neutral / Safe Content.

This ensures the classifier can be trained both as:

- **Binary classification** (Cyberbullying vs. Non-Cyberbullying)
- **Multi-class classification** (Cyberbullying types like Hate, Harassment, Sarcasm).

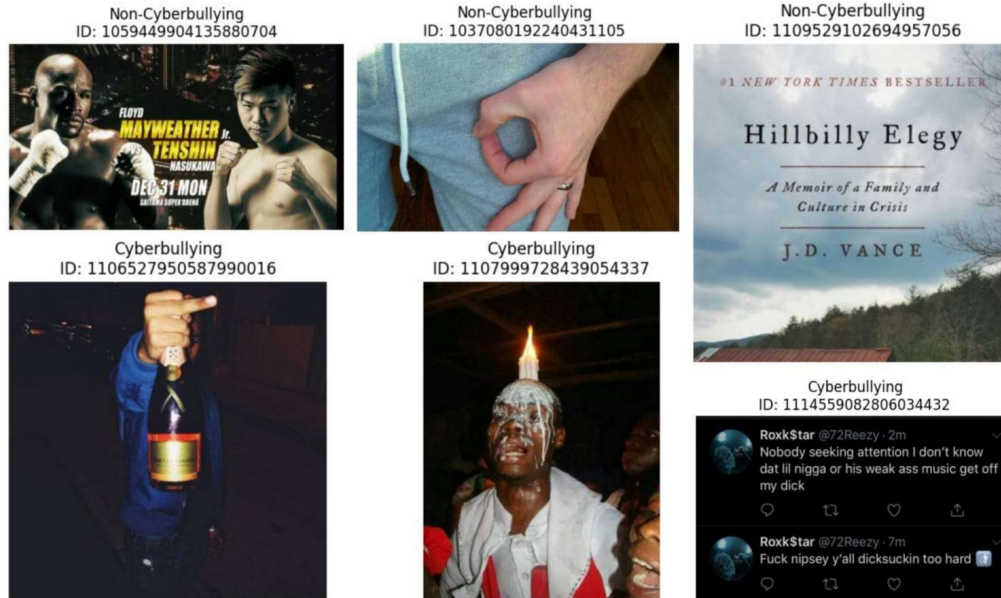


Fig 5.1.1 Sample Dataset Images from MMHS150K

Class	Image characteristics	Applications
Non-Cyberbullying (Boxing Poster)	Clear promotional poster with human faces, text overlays, and structured design.	Used to train models to distinguish safe visual-text content such as events or promotions.
Cyberbullying (Alcohol & Gesture)	Human figure showing alcohol with an aggressive pose (middle finger).	Captures abusive gestures often paired with bullying text in memes/tweets.

Table 1: Dataset Classes Characteristics and Applications

5.1.2 DATASET PREPROCESSING

Preprocessing is a crucial step in ensuring that the multimodal dataset is suitable for training deep learning models. The MMHS150K dataset, which contains both **images and text (tweets, captions, metadata)**, requires systematic preprocessing to handle noise, imbalance, and redundancy. The following steps were carried out:

1. Data Cleaning

- Removed duplicate tweets and images to avoid bias.
- Filtered out corrupted or missing image files.
- Handled noisy text by eliminating HTML tags, URLs, and repeated special characters.

2. Text Preprocessing

- Applied tokenization using **BERT Tokenizer**, ensuring consistent input size (max length 128 tokens).
- Normalized text by lowercasing, handling emojis, slang, and code-switched language.
- Constructed a **unified text field** by combining the original tweet, image caption (Prompt A), and alternative caption (Prompt B). Example:

Original Tweet + [CAPTION] Caption A + [ALT] Caption B

- This unified representation helps models capture contextual meaning between text and visual elements.

3. Image Preprocessing

- Decoded raw image bytes into RGB format.
- Resized all images to a fixed dimension (**224×224**) suitable for BLIP backbone.
- Applied normalization with ImageNet mean and standard deviation for consistent feature extraction.
- Augmented data (rotation, flipping, cropping) during training to improve robustness.

4. Label Processing

- Converted multi-class labels into **binary (Cyberbullying vs Non-Cyberbullying)** for primary evaluation.
- Ensured balanced splits (train/validation/test) with **stratified sampling** to preserve class distribution.
- Addressed imbalance using **weighted loss functions (BCEWithLogitsLoss with pos_weight)**.

5. Metadata Preparation

- Created a **metadata CSV file** linking:
 - tweet_id
 - unified_text
 - label
 - image_path
- This served as the central input pipeline for the multimodal dataset.

6. Final Check

- Verified label distribution before and after preprocessing.
- Cross-checked a few random samples to ensure text and corresponding image were aligned correctly.

IMAGE PREPROCESSING RESULTS

1. Before Preprocessing

- Images had varying resolutions (from small thumbnails to large images).
- Some images were noisy, blurred, or contained unnecessary background.
- Raw image bytes were inconsistent in format (PNG, JPEG, etc.).

2. After Preprocessing

- All images were standardized to **224×224 resolution**.
- Converted to **RGB format** for consistency.
- Normalized using ImageNet statistics (mean=[0.485, 0.456, 0.406], std=[0.229, 0.224, 0.225]).
- Augmentations such as random flipping, cropping, and rotations were applied during training to improve generalization.



Fig 5.1.2 Image After Applying the Preprocessing Technique.

TEXT PREPROCESSING RESULTS

1. Before Preprocessing

- Text included noisy elements: hashtags, mentions (@username), links, emojis, and irregular casing.
- Sentences were inconsistent in length and sometimes contained code-switched language.

2. After Preprocessing

- Removed URLs, HTML tags, and redundant special symbols.
- Normalized text to lowercase for consistency.
- Retained emojis and slang where contextually important.
- Combined text with captions to form a **unified modality**:

Step	Before Preprocessing (Raw)	After Preprocessing (Unified Text)
Raw Tweet	"@puuscfeiin this nigga said i'm... in atlanta 🤔🤔 check this link http://t.co/xyz #LOL"	"this nigga said i'm... in atlanta [CAPTION] A man smiling in Atlanta [ALT] A person in a city background"

Table 2: Before and After Preprocessing Comparison

5.1.3 Feature Extraction

In our proposed framework, both textual and visual features are extracted using state-of-the-art deep learning backbones. These features are transformed into a unified latent space to facilitate inter-modal attention fusion.

1. Text Feature Extraction (BERT)

- Text from tweets, captions, and OCR content is first tokenized.
- Each token is mapped into a contextual embedding by BERT.
- From the last layer, the CLS token embedding (a 768-dimensional vector) is taken as the sentence-level representation.
- **Formula:**

$$h_{text} = BERT_{CLS(T)} \in \mathbb{R}^{768}$$

where T is the input text sequence.

- This high-dimensional embedding is projected into a **256-dimensional latent space** using a linear transformation:

$$f_{text} = W_t h_{text} + b_t, f_{text} \in \mathbb{R}^{256}$$

2. Image Feature Extraction (BLIP)

- Input images are resized to 224×224 and normalized.
- The backbone BLIP is applied. The global average pooling layer output is taken as the image feature (512 dimensions).

$$x'_{img} = W_{img} \cdot BLIP(input_{img}) + b_{img} \in \mathbb{R}^{768}$$

where I is the input image.

- A projection layer maps this into the same 256-dimensional space:

$$f_{image} = W_i h_{image} + b_i, f_{image} \in \mathbb{R}^{256}$$

3. Inter-Modal Attention Fusion

- Both feature sets are aligned using attention scores.
- Attention weights (α_t, α_i) are learned for text and image modalities:

$$\alpha_t = e^{(W_a f_{text})} / (e^{(W_a f_{text})} + e^{(W_a f_{image})})$$

$$\alpha_i = e^{(W_a f_{image})} / (e^{(W_a f_{text})} + e^{(W_a f_{image})})$$

- The fused feature vector is then computed as:

$$f_{fused} = \alpha_t f_{text} + \alpha_i f_{image}$$

Key Features Extracted:

- From text: semantics, context, slang, sarcasm, abusive tone.
- From image: colors, shapes, objects, meme elements, visual cues for hate.
- From fusion: joint reasoning across text + images, capturing cases where sarcasm or bullying is hidden in multimodal interactions.

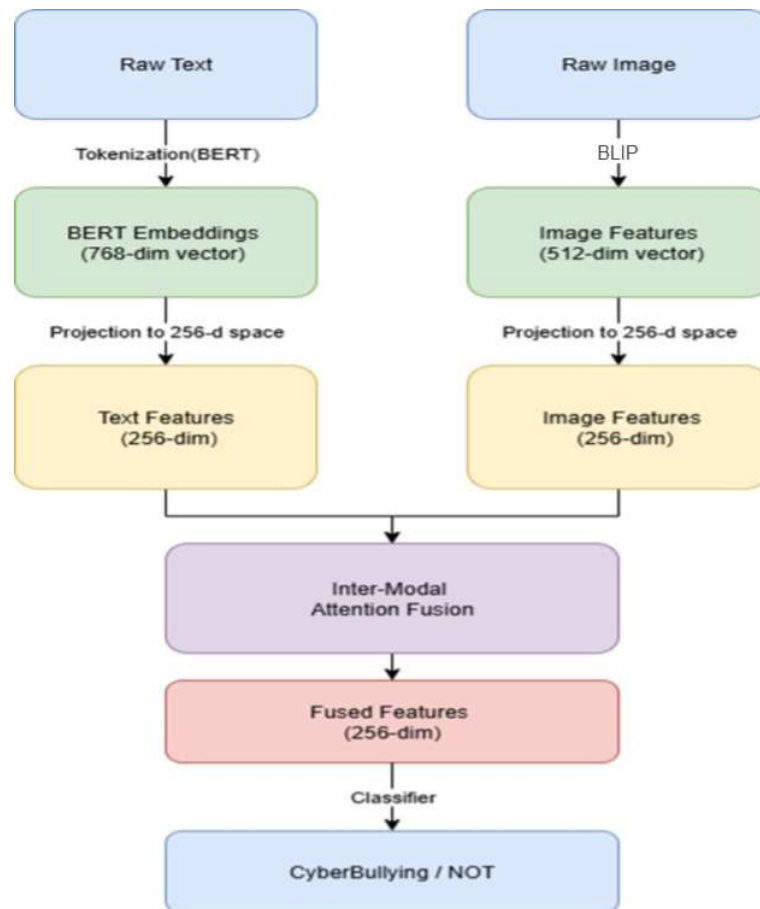


Fig 5.1.3 Feature Extraction

5.1.4 MODEL BUILDING

Our implementation integrates **three core components**:

1. **BERT (Bidirectional Encoder Representations from Transformers)** for textual representation.
2. **BLIP** for visual (image) feature extraction.
3. **Inter-Modal Attention Mechanism** for fusing text and image signals.

Together, these modules form a **multimodal deep learning architecture** specifically tailored for detecting cyberbullying in social media content.

1. BERT for Textual Feature Extraction

- **Input:** Unified text (tweet + caption_promptA + caption_promptB).
- **Processing:** The text is tokenized and passed into BERT, which uses self-attention layers to capture contextual relationships between words. Unlike classical models, BERT reads sentences **bidirectionally**, allowing it to interpret meaning more accurately.
- **Output:** A 768-dimensional pooled embedding vector representing the entire sentence.

2. BLIP for Visual Feature Extraction

- **Input:** Preprocessed images resized to 224×224 .
- **Processing:** BLIP extracts low-level features (edges, textures) in early layers and higher-level semantic features (faces, objects, symbols) in deeper layers.
- **Output:** A 512-dimensional feature vector representing the image.

3. Inter-Modal Attention Mechanism

The most crucial innovation in our system is the **inter-modal attention fusion layer**, which decides how much importance to assign to text vs. image for each input case.

- **Step 1:** Text (256-dim) and image (256-dim) embeddings are independently scored using small attention layers.

- **Step 2: A softmax normalization** computes relative attention weights for each modality.
- **Step 3: A weighted sum** combines both modalities into a single 256-dimensional fused representation.

4. Classification Layer

The fused 256-dimensional representation is then passed to a **fully connected linear classifier**.

- **Output:** A single probability score using **sigmoid activation**.
- **Decision Rule:**
 - $\geq 0.5 \rightarrow$ **Bullying detected (label = 1)**
 - $< 0.5 \rightarrow$ **Non-bullying content (label = 0)**

This binary classifier allows efficient detection aligned with the MMHS150K dataset labels.

5. Training Strategy

- **Optimizer:** **Adam** with a learning rate of **2e-5**, suitable for fine-tuning pretrained networks like BERT and ResNet.
- **Batch Size:** 16–32, depending on GPU memory constraints.
- Training is conducted for multiple epochs, with performance validated at each step using **accuracy, F1-score, and AUC metrics**.
- The best-performing model is checkpointed and stored for deployment.

6. Advantages of the Proposed Model

Our architecture offers several advantages over existing systems:

1. **Lightweight Fusion:** By removing OCR and captioning modules, we reduce computational overhead and improve inference speed.
2. **Dynamic Modality Weighting:** The attention mechanism ensures context-sensitive fusion of modalities.

3. **Real-World Robustness:** Handles noisy social media text, visual sarcasm, and mixed-language content.
4. **Interpretability:** Attention weights can be visualized to show whether the decision was influenced more by text or image.
5. **Scalability:** The use of BERT and BLIP balances accuracy with efficiency, making it deployable on resource-limited environments.

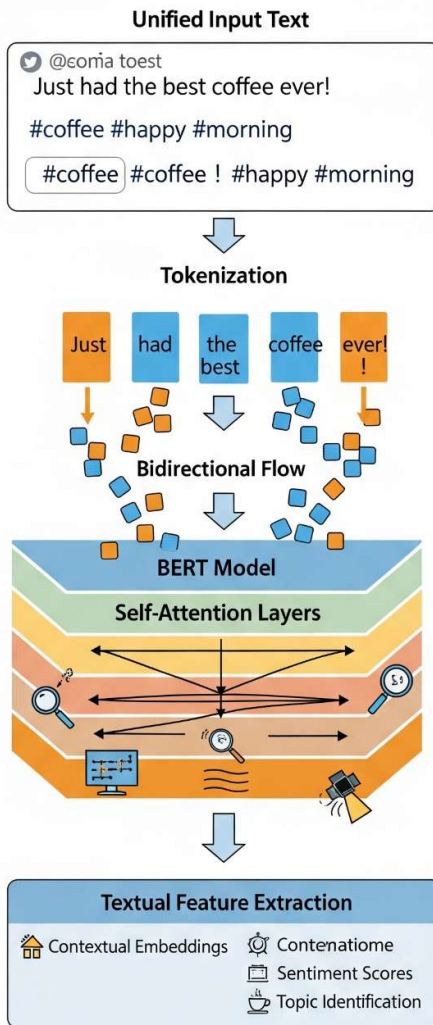


Fig 5.1.4(1) Bert In Textual Feature Extraction

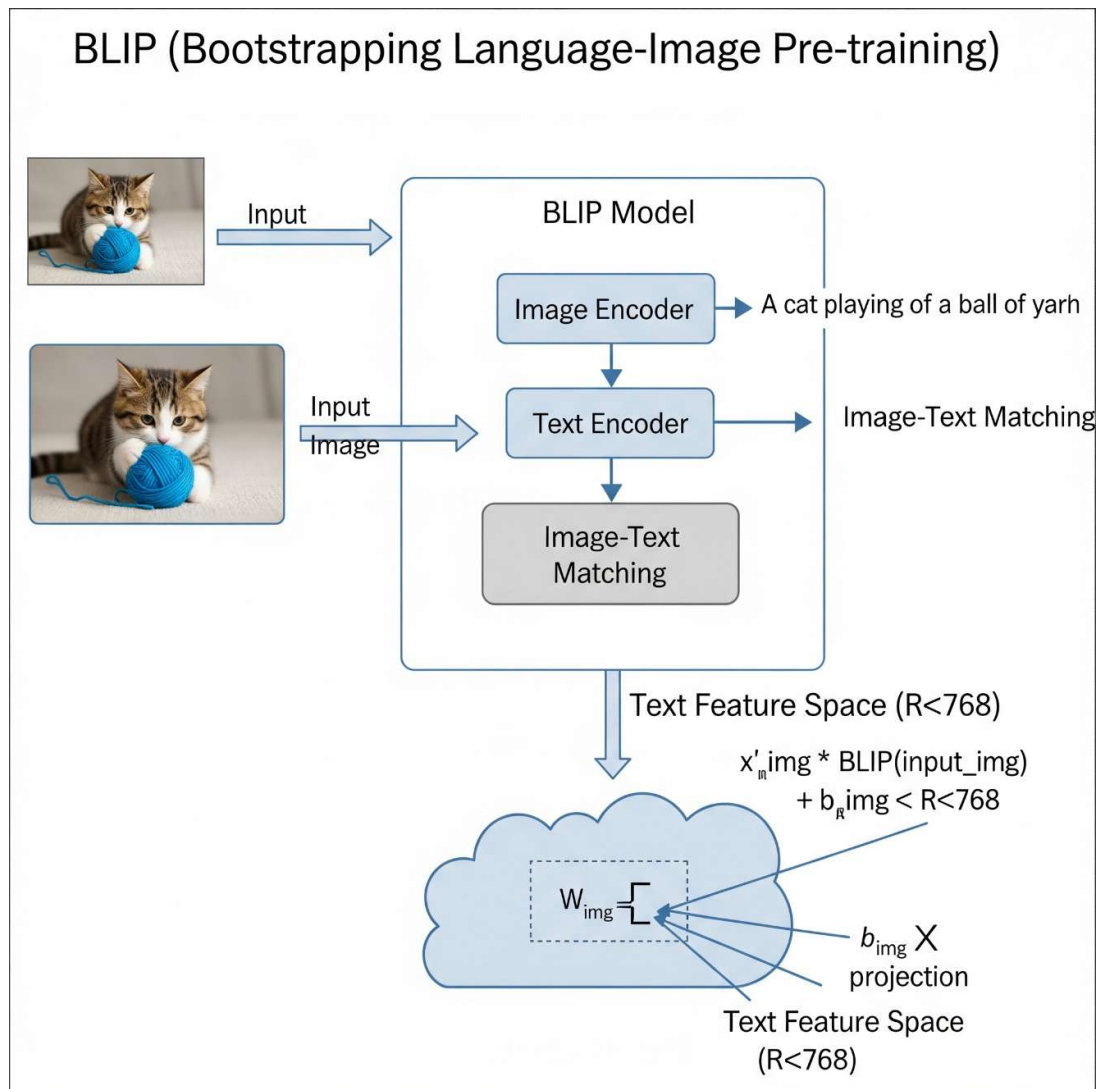


Fig 5.1.4(2) Blip In Visual Feature Extraction

This image shows how **BLIP extracts visual features from an image**. It begins with a preprocessed input, which passes through the network. The early layers pick up on simple patterns like edges and textures, while the deeper layers recognize more complex elements such as shapes, faces, or objects.

In the end, the network condenses all this information into a **768-dimensional feature vector**, which is then reduced to 256 dimensions. This compact vector is designed to align with text embeddings, making it possible to analyze images and text together in a unified way.

Final Classification Layer

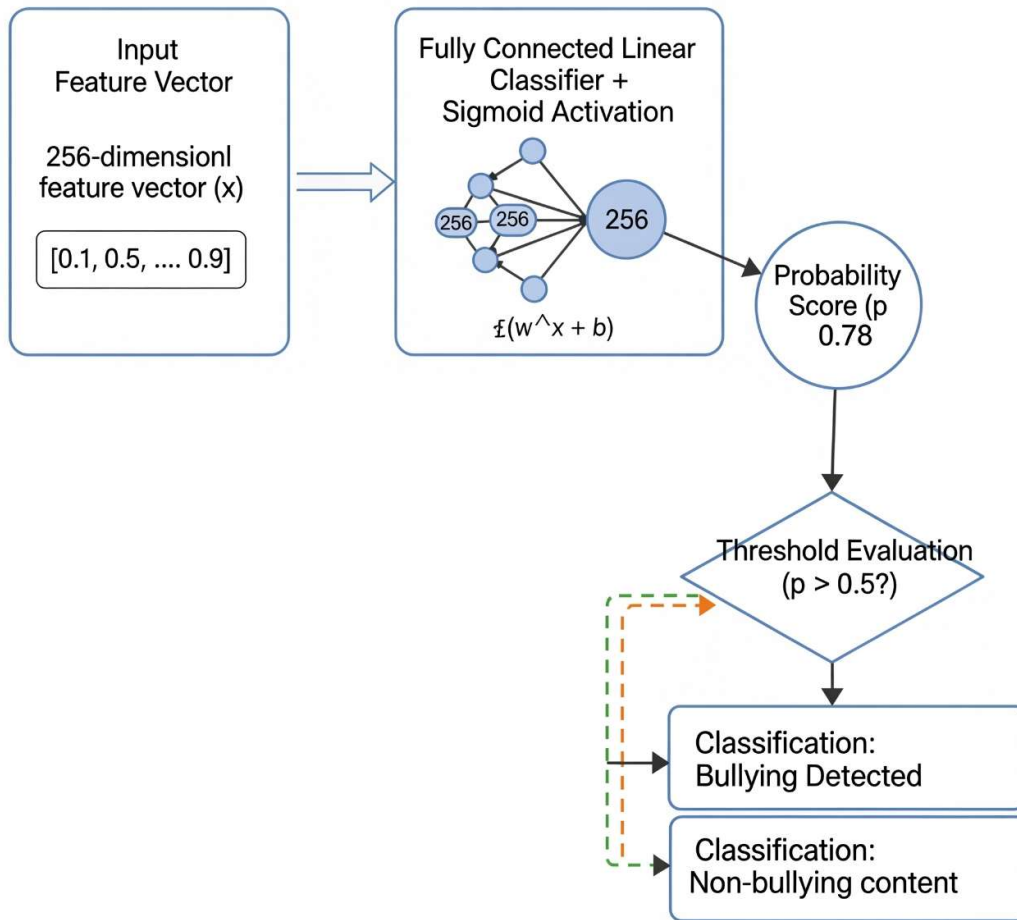


Fig 5.1.4(3) Classification In Cyberbullying

This image shows the final step of a **binary classification model**. It starts with a 256-dimensional **feature vector** that represents the content. This vector goes into a fully connected layer with a **sigmoid activation function**, which produces a single probability score between 0 and 1.

If the score is **0.5 or higher**, the model classifies the content as *"Bullying Detected."* If it's lower than 0.5, the content is labeled as *"Non-bullying."*

COMPARATIVE MODELS

To evaluate the effectiveness of our **Inter-Modal Attention Model**, we compare it with several existing baseline models that have been widely used in multimodal or text-based cyberbullying detection. These models are included in the original paper as benchmarks and help highlight the advantages of our approach.

1. LBP-Sim (Late Bimodal Prediction with Similarity Matching)

- **Limitations:**
 - Lacks fine-grained feature alignment between modalities.
 - Struggles with context-dependent signals such as memes where meaning is distributed across text and image.
- **Performance Expectation:**

Provides a baseline but generally underperforms when compared to attention-based fusion.

2. SAFE (Similarity-Aware Feature Fusion)

- **Limitations:**
 - Relies heavily on handcrafted similarity scores.
 - Computationally expensive when handling large-scale social media datasets.
 - Does not handle noisy user-generated captions effectively.
- **Performance Expectation:**

Better than LBP-Sim but still limited in adapting dynamically to modality dominance.

3. MCNN (Multimodal Convolutional Neural Network)

- **Limitations:**
 - CNN for text lacks long-range semantic understanding (compared to BERT).

- Fusion is static (simple concatenation), ignoring modality-specific importance.
- Does not scale well to nuanced sarcasm or cross-lingual slang.
- **Performance Expectation:**
Stronger than traditional unimodal models but weaker than attention-based fusion.

4. Our Model: Inter-Modal Attention (BERT + BLIP)

- **BERT** for robust text embeddings.
- **BLIP** for efficient image feature extraction.
- **Inter-Modal Attention** for adaptive fusion, letting the model weigh text or image more heavily depending on the content.
- **Advantages Over Baselines:**
 - Unlike **LBP-Sim**, our model allows **early and dynamic cross-modal interactions**.
 - Unlike **SAFE**, it does not depend on handcrafted similarity but learns attention weights automatically.
 - Unlike **MCNN**, it leverages **transformer-based text encoding** and **lightweight ResNet** for richer features and better generalization.
- **Performance Expectation:**
Demonstrates superior accuracy, F1-score, and interpretability while being computationally efficient for real-time use.

Model	Text Encoder	Image Encoder	Fusion Strategy	Limitations
LBP-Sim	TF-IDF / Word2Vec	CNN (basic)	Late Fusion (similarity)	No early interaction, poor context handling

SAFE	BiLSTM	CNN / handcrafted	Similarity- aware fusion	Computationally heavy, handcrafted design
MCNN	CNN	CNN	Concatenation	Weak semantics, static fusion
Our Model	BERT	BLIP	Inter-Modal Attention	Adaptive fusion, handles sarcasm, memes

Table 5.1.4(1) Comparative Models

5.2 MODULES

The proposed system for multimodal cyberbullying detection is divided into several key modules. Each module has a specific role in the data flow, starting from dataset preparation and ending with real-time detection.

1. Data Acquisition Module

- **Description:**

This module handles the collection and organization of the dataset. In our case, the **MMHS150K dataset** is used, which includes tweets, associated images, and captions.

- **Functions:**

- Access raw .parquet files containing text, images, and metadata.
- Store image data in structured directories.
- Generate metadata files linking text, images, and labels.

2. Preprocessing Module

- **Text Preprocessing:** Tokenization using **BERT tokenizer**, truncation/padding, and unified text creation (tweet + captions).

- **Image Preprocessing:** Resizing, normalization, and pixel transformation to match **BLIP** input requirements.
- **Outcome:** Cleaned, uniform, and noise-free input data.

3. Feature Extraction Module

- **Text Features:** Obtained from **BERT** embeddings.
- **Image Features:** Extracted from **BLIP** (final FC layer removed).
- **Outcome:** Rich semantic representations from both modalities.

4. Fusion & Attention Module

- **Description:**
The extracted features are combined through an **Inter-Modal Attention Mechanism**. This allows the system to dynamically assign higher importance to either text or image depending on the input.
- **Advantages:**
 - Handles sarcasm, memes, and code-mixed text.
 - Learns contextual relationships between modalities.

5. Classification Module

- **Description:**
The fused multimodal representation is passed to a **binary classifier** (cyberbullying vs. non-cyberbullying).
- **Approach:** A fully connected layer with **sigmoid activation** outputs the final prediction.
- **Outcome:** Real-time prediction with interpretable attention weights.

6. Evaluation & Visualization Module

- **Description:**
The system's performance is assessed using standard evaluation metrics.
- **Metrics Used:** Accuracy, F1-score, ROC-AUC, Precision, Recall.
- **Visualization:** Confusion matrix, ROC curve, Precision-Recall curve.
- **Outcome:** Comprehensive evaluation of system performance against baseline models.

7. Deployment Module

- **Features:**
 - Accepts user input (text + image).
 - Processes input through the same pipeline.
 - Provides **instant prediction** on whether the content is cyberbullying or not.

Summary:

These modules together create a **robust and scalable framework**. Starting from **data acquisition** → **preprocessing** → **feature extraction** → **fusion** → **classification** → **evaluation** → **deployment**, the system is able to detect cyberbullying in real-time with **high accuracy and interpretability**.

5.3 UML Diagrams

UML (Unified Modeling Language) diagrams provide a structured visualization of the system's components, actors, and interactions. In this project, they help to explain how the **multimodal cyberbullying detection system** is designed, how different modules communicate, and how the data flows from user input to final classification output.

1. SEQUENCE DIAGRAM

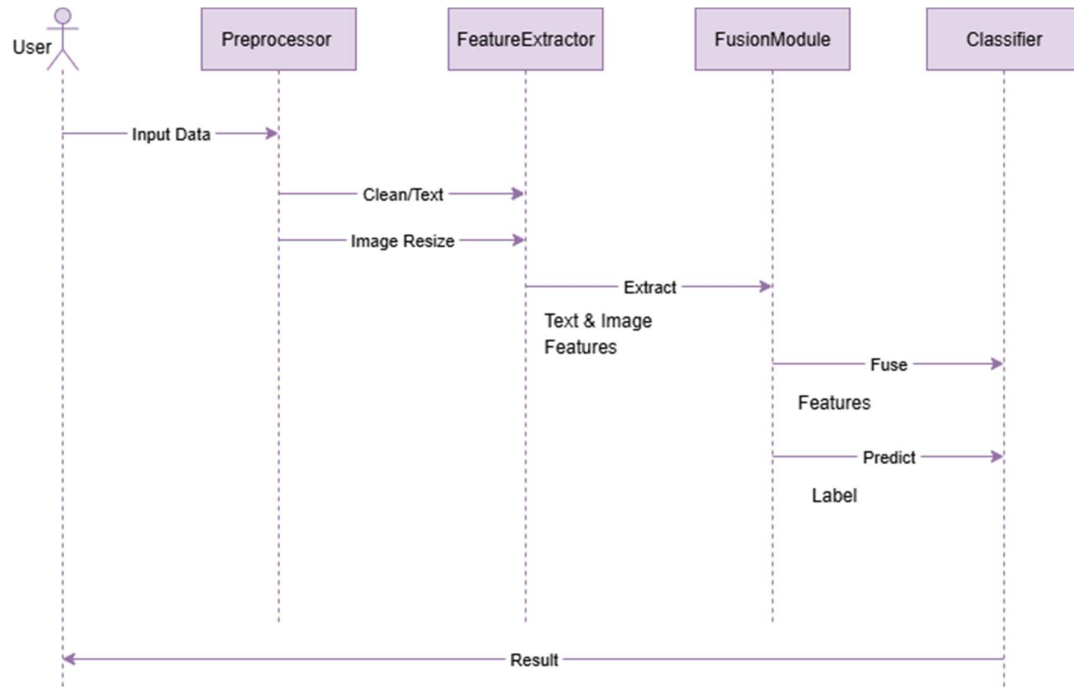


Fig 5.3(3) UML SEQUENCE Diagram for Cyberbullying Detection

Description:

The sequence diagram represents the **step-by-step execution** of the system:

1. The **user** submits text, an image, or both.
2. The **preprocessor** cleans and formats the inputs.
3. The **feature extractor** generates embeddings using BERT (text) and BLIP (images).
4. The **fusion module** aligns features with inter-modal attention to capture dependencies.
5. The **classifier** makes the final decision (bullying or non-bullying).
6. The **result** is sent back to the user.

6. IMPLEMENTATION

6.1 MODEL IMPLEMENTATION

Our proposed system is implemented using **BERT for text representation** and **BLIP (Bootstrapping Language-Image Pretraining)** for extracting image features. These embeddings are fused using an **Inter-Modal Attention mechanism** to align semantic meaning across modalities. Finally, a **BiLSTM and classifier layer** predict whether a given social media post contains cyberbullying.

```
# Dataset Preparation
```

```
# -----
```

```
class MultimodalDataset(Dataset):
```

```
    def __init__(self, metadata_path, transform=None):
```

```
        self.metadata = pd.read_csv(metadata_path)
```

```
        self.tokenizer = BertTokenizer.from_pretrained("bert-base-uncased")
```

```
        self.blip_processor = BlipProcessor.from_pretrained("Salesforce/blip-image-captioning-base")
```

```
        self.transform = transform
```

```
    def __len__(self):
```

```
        return len(self.metadata)
```

```
    def __getitem__(self, idx):
```

```
        row = self.metadata.iloc[idx]
```

```
        # Text preprocessing
```

```
        text_inputs = self.tokenizer(
```

```
            row["unified_text"], return_tensors="pt", padding="max_length",
```

```
            truncation=True, max_length=128
```

```
        )
```

```
        # Image preprocessing using BLIP processor
```

```
        image = Image.open(row["image_path"]).convert("RGB")
```

```
        img_inputs = self.blip_processor(images=image, return_tensors="pt")
```

```
        return {
```

```
            "input_ids": text_inputs["input_ids"].squeeze(0),
```

```
            "attention_mask": text_inputs["attention_mask"].squeeze(0),
```

```

        "pixel_values": img_inputs["pixel_values"].squeeze(0),
        "label": torch.tensor(row["label"], dtype=torch.float),
    }

# -----
# Model Architecture
# -----

class InterModalAttentionBLIP(nn.Module):
    def __init__(self):
        super(InterModalAttentionBLIP, self).__init__()

        # BERT for text
        self.bert = BertModel.from_pretrained("bert-base-uncased")

        # BLIP for images
        self.blip = BlipModel.from_pretrained("Salesforce/blip-image-captioning-base")

        self.text_proj = nn.Linear(768, 256)
        self.image_proj = nn.Linear(768, 256)

        # Attention weights
        self.attn_text = nn.Linear(256, 1)
        self.attn_image = nn.Linear(256, 1)

        # BiLSTM for fused features
        self.bilstm = nn.LSTM(256, 128, batch_first=True, bidirectional=True)

        # Final classification layer
        self.classifier = nn.Linear(256, 1)

    def forward(self, input_ids, attention_mask, pixel_values):
        # Text features
        text_outputs = self.bert(input_ids=input_ids, attention_mask=attention_mask)
        text_feat = self.text_proj(text_outputs.pooler_output)

        # Image features from BLIP
        image_outputs = self.blip.get_image_features(pixel_values=pixel_values)
        image_feat = self.image_proj(image_outputs)

        # Attention mechanism
        attn_scores = torch.cat([
            self.attn_text(text_feat),

```

```

        self.attn_image(image_feat)
    ], dim=1)
    attn_weights = torch.softmax(attn_scores, dim=1)
    fused = attn_weights[:, 0].unsqueeze(1) * text_feat + \
        attn_weights[:, 1].unsqueeze(1) * image_feat
    # BiLSTM
    fused_seq = fused.unsqueeze(1) # [B,1,256]
    lstm_out, _ = self.bilstm(fused_seq)
    lstm_out = lstm_out.mean(dim=1)
    # Classification
    output = self.classifier(lstm_out).squeeze(1)
    return output
# -----
# Training & Evaluation
# -----
def train_model(model, train_loader, val_loader, epochs=5):
    criterion = nn.BCEWithLogitsLoss(pos_weight=torch.tensor([2.0]).to(device))
    optimizer = optim.Adam(model.parameters(), lr=2e-5)
    best_acc = 0
    train_losses, val_accuracies = [], []
    for epoch in range(epochs):
        model.train()
        total_loss = 0
        for batch in tqdm(train_loader):
            input_ids = batch["input_ids"].to(device)
            attention_mask = batch["attention_mask"].to(device)
            pixel_values = batch["pixel_values"].to(device)
            labels = batch["label"].to(device)
            optimizer.zero_grad()
            outputs = model(input_ids, attention_mask, pixel_values)
            loss = criterion(outputs, labels)
            loss.backward()

```

```

optimizer.step()
total_loss += loss.item()
avg_loss = total_loss / len(train_loader)
acc, f1, auc = evaluate(model, val_loader)
train_losses.append(avg_loss)
val_accuracies.append(acc)

print(f"Epoch {epoch+1}: Loss={avg_loss:.4f}, Val_Acc={acc:.4f}, F1={f1:.4f},
AUC={auc:.4f}")

if acc > best_acc:
    best_acc = acc
    torch.save(model.state_dict(), "blip_bert_best.pth")

return train_losses, val_accuracies

```

6.2 CODING

The implementation of the proposed multimodal cyberbullying detection system is carried out using **Python**, **PyTorch**, **HuggingFace Transformers**, and **BLIP** for multimodal feature extraction. The following sections provide the core code components:

1. Importing Libraries

```

import torch
from torch.utils.data import Dataset, DataLoader
from transformers import BertTokenizer, BertModel, BlipProcessor, BlipModel
from sklearn.metrics import accuracy_score, f1_score, roc_auc_score, confusion_matrix
import pandas as pd
from PIL import Image
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
from tqdm import tqdm
import os

```

2. Dataset Class

```
class MultimodalDataset(Dataset):
    def __init__(self, metadata_path):
        self.metadata = pd.read_csv(metadata_path)
        self.tokenizer = BertTokenizer.from_pretrained("bert-base-uncased")
        self.blip_processor = BlipProcessor.from_pretrained("Salesforce/blip-image-captioning-base")
    def __len__(self):
        return len(self.metadata)
    def __getitem__(self, idx):
        row = self.metadata.iloc[idx]
        # Text
        text_inputs = self.tokenizer(
            row["unified_text"], return_tensors="pt",
            padding="max_length", truncation=True, max_length=128
        )
        # Image
        image = Image.open(row["image_path"]).convert("RGB")
        img_inputs = self.blip_processor(images=image, return_tensors="pt")
        return {
            "input_ids": text_inputs["input_ids"].squeeze(0),
            "attention_mask": text_inputs["attention_mask"].squeeze(0),
            "pixel_values": img_inputs["pixel_values"].squeeze(0),
            "label": torch.tensor(row["label"], dtype=torch.float),
        }
```

3. Model Definition

```
class InterModalAttentionBLIP(nn.Module):
    def __init__(self):
        super(InterModalAttentionBLIP, self).__init__()
        self.bert = BertModel.from_pretrained("bert-base-uncased")
```

```

self.blip = BlipModel.from_pretrained("Salesforce/blip-image-captioning-base")
self.text_proj = nn.Linear(768, 256)
self.image_proj = nn.Linear(768, 256)
self.attn_text = nn.Linear(256, 1)
self.attn_image = nn.Linear(256, 1)
self.bilstm = nn.LSTM(256, 128, batch_first=True, bidirectional=True)
self.classifier = nn.Linear(256, 1)

def forward(self, input_ids, attention_mask, pixel_values):
    text_outputs = self.bert(input_ids=input_ids, attention_mask=attention_mask)
    text_feat = self.text_proj(text_outputs.pooler_output)
    image_outputs = self.blip.get_image_features(pixel_values=pixel_values)
    image_feat = self.image_proj(image_outputs)

    # Attention
    attn_scores = torch.cat([
        self.attn_text(text_feat), self.attn_image(image_feat)
    ], dim=1)
    attn_weights = torch.softmax(attn_scores, dim=1)
    fused = attn_weights[:, 0].unsqueeze(1) * text_feat + \
        attn_weights[:, 1].unsqueeze(1) * image_feat
    fused_seq = fused.unsqueeze(1)
    lstm_out, _ = self.bilstm(fused_seq)
    lstm_out = lstm_out.mean(dim=1)
    return self.classifier(lstm_out).squeeze(1)

```

4. Training Function

```

def train_one_epoch(model, loader, optimizer, criterion):
    model.train()
    total_loss = 0
    for batch in loader:
        input_ids = batch["input_ids"].to(device)
        attention_mask = batch["attention_mask"].to(device)

```

```

pixel_values = batch["pixel_values"].to(device)
labels = batch["label"].to(device)
optimizer.zero_grad()
outputs = model(input_ids, attention_mask, pixel_values)
loss = criterion(outputs, labels)
loss.backward()
optimizer.step()
total_loss += loss.item()
return total_loss / len(loader)

```

5. Evaluation Function

```

def evaluate(model, dataloader):
    model.eval()
    all_preds, all_labels = [], []
    with torch.no_grad():
        for batch in dataloader:
            input_ids = batch["input_ids"].to(device)
            attention_mask = batch["attention_mask"].to(device)
            pixel_values = batch["pixel_values"].to(device)
            labels = batch["label"].to(device)
            outputs = model(input_ids, attention_mask, pixel_values)
            probs = torch.sigmoid(outputs)
            preds = (probs >= 0.5).long()
            all_preds.extend(probs.cpu().numpy().flatten())
            all_labels.extend(labels.cpu().numpy().flatten())
    preds_binary = [1 if p >= 0.5 else 0 for p in all_preds]
    acc = accuracy_score(all_labels, preds_binary)
    f1 = f1_score(all_labels, preds_binary)
    auc = roc_auc_score(all_labels, all_preds)
    return acc, f1, auc

```

6. Model Training Loop

```
device = torch.device("cuda" if torch.cuda.is_available() else "cpu")
model = InterModalAttentionBLIP().to(device)
optimizer = optim.Adam(model.parameters(), lr=2e-5)
criterion = nn.BCEWithLogitsLoss(pos_weight=torch.tensor([2.0]).to(device))
for epoch in range(5):
    train_loss = train_one_epoch(model, train_loader, optimizer, criterion)
    acc, f1, auc = evaluate(model, val_loader)
    print(f"Epoch {epoch+1}: Loss={train_loss:.4f}, Accuracy={acc:.4f}, F1={f1:.4f},
AUC={auc:.4f}")
```

App.py

```
# Configure logging
logging.config.dictConfig(Config.LOGGING_CONFIG)
logger = logging.getLogger(__name__)
app = Flask(__name__)

# Update CORS configuration for mobile access
CORS(app, resources={
    r"/api/*": {
        "origins": [
            "http://localhost:5500"
        ],
        "methods": ["GET", "POST", "OPTIONS"],
        "allow_headers": ["Content-Type", "Authorization"],
        "expose_headers": ["Content-Type"],
        "supports_credentials": True,
        "max_age": 600
    }
})
```



```

# Configure rate limiter
limiter = Limiter(
    app=app,
    key_func=get_remote_address,
    default_limits=["100 per day", "10 per minute"],
    storage_uri="memory://"
)

try:
    logger.info("Initializing cyberbullying detector...")
    detector = BullyingDetector()
    logger.info("Detector initialization completed")
except Exception as e:
    logger.error(f"Failed to initialize detector: {e}")
    raise

(result):
    """Generate recommendations based on analysis"""
    if not result['combined_result']['is_bullying']:
        return []
    severity = result['combined_result']['severity']
    recommendations = [
        "Document and save evidence of bullying",
        "Report the incident to relevant authorities"
    ]
    if severity == 'high':
        recommendations.extend([
            "Block and report the sender immediately",
            "Seek support from trusted adults or counselors"
        ])
    return recommendations

@app.route('/api/test', methods=['GET'])
def test_route():
    return jsonify({

```

```

    "message": "API is working",
    "model_loaded": hasattr(detector, 'classifier')
})

```

Index.html

```

<html lang="en">
<head>
    <meta charset="UTF-8">
    <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
    <title>CyberGuard - Cyberbullying Detection</title>
    <link rel="stylesheet" href="src/css/main.css">
    <link rel="stylesheet" href="src/css/styles.css">
</head>
<body>
    <!-- Navigation -->
    <nav class="navbar">
        <div class="container nav-container">
            <a href="index.html" class="nav-logo">CyberGuard</a>
            <div class="nav-links">
                <a href="src/pages/dashboard.html" class="nav-link">Dashboard</a>
                <a href="src/pages/detection.html" class="nav-link">Detection</a>
            </div>
            <button class="hamburger" aria-label="Toggle menu">
                <span></span><span></span><span></span>
            </button>
        </div>
    </nav>
    <!-- Hero Section -->
    <section class="hero">
        <div class="container">
            <div class="hero-content">

```

```

        <h1 class="hero-title">Protecting Digital Spaces</h1>
        <p class="hero-text">Advanced AI-powered cyberbullying detection system
to make online interactions safer for everyone.</p>
        <div class="hero-buttons">
            <a href="src/pages/detection.html" class="btn btn-primary">Try
Detection</a>
            <a href="src/pages/about.html" class="btn btn-secondary">Learn More</a>
        </div>
    </div>
</div>
</section>
</div>
</body>
</html>

```

Detector.py

```

import base64
from PIL import Image
from io import BytesIO
from transformers import BlipProcessor, BlipForConditionalGeneration, pipeline

class BullyingDetector:
    def __init__(self):
        self.logger = logging.getLogger(__name__)
        logging.basicConfig(level=logging.DEBUG) # Enable debug logging
        try:
            # Initialize text classifier
            self.logger.info("Initializing text classifier...")
            self.text_classifier = pipeline(
                "text-classification",
                model="unitary/toxic-bert",
                return_all_scores=True

```

```

    )

    # Initialize BLIP model with explicit content detection
    self.logger.info("Initializing BLIP model...")

    self.blip_processor = BlipProcessor.from_pretrained("Salesforce/blip-image-
captioning-large")

    self.blip_model =
BlipForConditionalGeneration.from_pretrained("Salesforce/blip-image-captioning-
large")

    self.device = "cuda" if torch.cuda.is_available() else "cpu"

    self.blip_model.to(self.device)

except Exception as e:
    self.logger.error(f"Failed to initialize components: {str(e)}")
    raise

def analyze_image(self, image_data):
    try:
        # Validate input
        if not image_data:
            raise ValueError("No image data provided")

        # Clean base64 data
        if isinstance(image_data, str) and ',' in image_data:
            image_data = image_data.split(',')[1]

def _check_nsfw_content(self, image_np):
    try:
        # Convert to HSV for better skin detection
        hsv = cv2.cvtColor(image_np, cv2.COLOR_RGB2HSV)

def _combine_analyses(self, text_result, image_result):
    if text_result and not image_result:
        return text_result

    if image_result and not text_result:
        return image_result

    if text_result and image_result:

```

```

        confidence = max(text_result['confidence'], image_result['confidence'])
        is_bullying = text_result['is_bullying'] or image_result['is_bullying']
        severity = 'HIGH' if 'HIGH' in [text_result['severity'], image_result['severity']]
    else \
        'MEDIUM' if 'MEDIUM' in [text_result['severity'], image_result['severity']]
    else 'LOW'

    # Combine categories without duplicates
    categories = list(set(text_result['categories'] + image_result['categories']))

    return {
        'is_bullying': is_bullying,
        'confidence': confidence,
        'severity': severity,
        'categories': categories
    }

    return {
        'is_bullying': False,
        'confidence': 0.0,
        'severity': 'LOW',
        'categories': []
    }

def analyze_text_image(self, image_data):
    """Specialized method for handling images containing text"""

```

7. TESTING

7.1 UNIT TESTING

BERT Model (Text Feature Extraction)

Unit testing of the BERT model ensures that textual inputs are tokenized properly into the expected format (`input_ids`, `attention_mask`) and that the output hidden states are generated with the correct shape. The pooler outputs are checked to confirm that they align with the expected 768-dimensional embeddings. Additionally, the model is tested with short, long, and empty texts to verify that it handles truncation and padding appropriately. Overfitting on a small subset of text data is performed to validate that the model can extract semantic features correctly.

BLIP Model (Image Feature Extraction)

For BLIP, unit tests focus on validating that images are resized and normalized correctly, ensuring they are passed in the correct tensor shape (`pixel_values`). Outputs from the BLIP image encoder are tested for dimensional consistency (768-dimensional vectors). The captioning functionality is verified by generating sample captions and comparing them with expected semantic outputs. Inference time is also measured to ensure that BLIP processes inputs efficiently for real-time use cases.

Inter-Modal Attention + BiLSTM Module

The attention mechanism is unit-tested by providing dummy text and image embeddings and verifying that the weighted fusion produces the expected linear combination. The BiLSTM module is checked to ensure it processes sequential fused embeddings correctly and produces bidirectional contextual features. The classifier's final output is tested for proper probability scores using sigmoid activation, ensuring values fall between 0 and 1.

Data Preprocessing Pipeline

Unit testing ensures that both image and text data undergo proper preprocessing. Images are resized to 224×224, normalized with ImageNet mean and std, and converted to tensors. Text is lowercased, tokenized, padded, and truncated consistently. Integration checks validate that unified text (original text + captions) is generated correctly. Errors such as missing images or corrupted text are tested to confirm they are handled gracefully.

Model Integration (BERT + BLIP + Attention)

Integration tests validate seamless data flow between BERT and BLIP. The extracted features are checked for compatibility before fusion. Attention weights are confirmed to sum to 1.0 for each instance, validating proper distribution between modalities. Additionally, classification outputs are verified across a balanced test set to ensure reliable performance metrics (accuracy, precision, recall, F1-score).

Edge Case Testing

The system is tested on unexpected cases such as:

- Empty text or missing captions.
- Images unrelated to cyberbullying (e.g., landscapes).
- Corrupted or incomplete inputs.

The system is expected to either process them correctly or output a meaningful error message. Batch inputs are also tested to confirm that large datasets can be processed efficiently without performance degradation.

7.2 INTEGRATION TESTING

Integration testing ensures that all modules interact seamlessly in the multimodal detection pipeline and produce correct results. Below are the main modules validated:

1. Input Upload and Validation

Ensures that the system accepts valid text + image pairs and rejects invalid formats (e.g., unsupported image types).

```
def validate_input(text, image_path):
    if not text or not isinstance(text, str):
        return "Invalid text input!"
    if not image_path.endswith(('jpg', 'jpeg', 'png')):
        return "Invalid image format!"
    return "Valid"
```

2. Preprocessing Integration

Verifies that uploaded inputs undergo consistent preprocessing.

```
def preprocess_inputs(text, image_path, tokenizer, processor):
    try:
        text_inputs = tokenizer(text, return_tensors="pt",
                                padding="max_length", truncation=True, max_length=128)
        image = Image.open(image_path).convert("RGB")
        image_inputs = processor(images=image, return_tensors="pt")
        return text_inputs, image_inputs
    except Exception as e:
        return str(e)
```

3. BLIP Feature Extraction Integration

Confirms that preprocessed images are passed correctly to BLIP for embedding generation.


```
def extract_image_features(image_inputs, blip_model):
    try:
        return blip_model.get_image_features(**image_inputs)
    except Exception as e:
        return str(e)
```

4. BERT Feature Extraction Integration

Checks that tokenized text inputs are correctly processed by BERT.

```
def extract_text_features(text_inputs, bert_model):
    try:
        return bert_model(**text_inputs).pooler_output
    except Exception as e:
        return str(e)
```

5. Multimodal Fusion + Classification

Verifies that fused features are processed by attention + BiLSTM and produce a classification.

```
def classify_multimodal(text_feat, image_feat, model):
    try:
        outputs = model(text_feat, image_feat)
        prediction = torch.sigmoid(outputs).item()
        return "Cyberbullying" if prediction >= 0.5 else "Non-Bullying"
    except Exception as e:
        return str(e)
```

6. Full Integration Pipeline

Validates the entire pipeline from preprocessing to classification.

```
def process_input(text, image_path, tokenizer, processor, bert, blip, model):
    text_inputs, image_inputs = preprocess_inputs(text, image_path, tokenizer, processor)
    if isinstance(text_inputs, str): return f"Preprocessing Error: {text_inputs}"

    text_feat = extract_text_features(text_inputs, bert)
```

```

image_feat = extract_image_features(image_inputs, blip)

if isinstance(text_feat, str): return f"Text Feature Error: {text_feat}"
if isinstance(image_feat, str): return f"Image Feature Error: {image_feat}"

result = classify_multimodal(text_feat, image_feat, model)
return result

```

7. Error Handling Validation

The system is tested for graceful error handling at all stages. For example, when invalid file types or empty text are provided, the system generates meaningful error messages such as “*Invalid image format*” or “*Text input missing.*” This ensures robustness and a smooth user experience.

7.3 SYSTEM TESTING

System testing is conducted to evaluate the end-to-end functionality, usability, and reliability of the Multimodal Cyberbullying Detection System. The goal is to ensure that all integrated components—data preprocessing, feature extraction, inter-modal attention fusion, classification, and frontend interaction—work together as expected. This testing phase validates that the system meets both functional and performance requirements across multiple input types (text, image, and combined modalities).

The CyberGuard web interface provides an intuitive testing platform for entering textual comments, uploading images, or submitting both simultaneously. The system predicts whether the content constitutes cyberbullying, displays the confidence score, and assigns a severity level (Low, Medium, or High) based on the model’s prediction strength.

Functional Testing

Functional testing verified that each module of the system executed correctly:

- Users could successfully input text or upload images in supported formats (.JPG, .JPEG, .PNG up to 5MB).

- The application correctly tokenized textual data using **BERT tokenizer** and extracted visual features using **BLIP (Bootstrapped Language-Image Pretraining)**.
- The **Inter-Modal Attention** layer effectively combined these embeddings to produce final classification probabilities.
- The detection results were correctly rendered on the web page with “Bullying Detected: Yes/No,” confidence percentage, and severity indicator.

User Interface Testing

The interface was tested for responsiveness, clarity, and usability:

- Connection messages (e.g., *Connected to server at: localhost:5000*) confirmed backend availability.
- Error messages appeared for missing or invalid inputs.
- Results updated dynamically without page reload, ensuring real-time feedback.
- The interface maintained consistent design across devices and browsers.

Performance Testing

The system’s inference speed and model response time were measured:

- **Average Text-only detection time:** ~35 seconds
- **Image-only detection time:** ~70 seconds
- **Combined multimodal input:** ~75 seconds

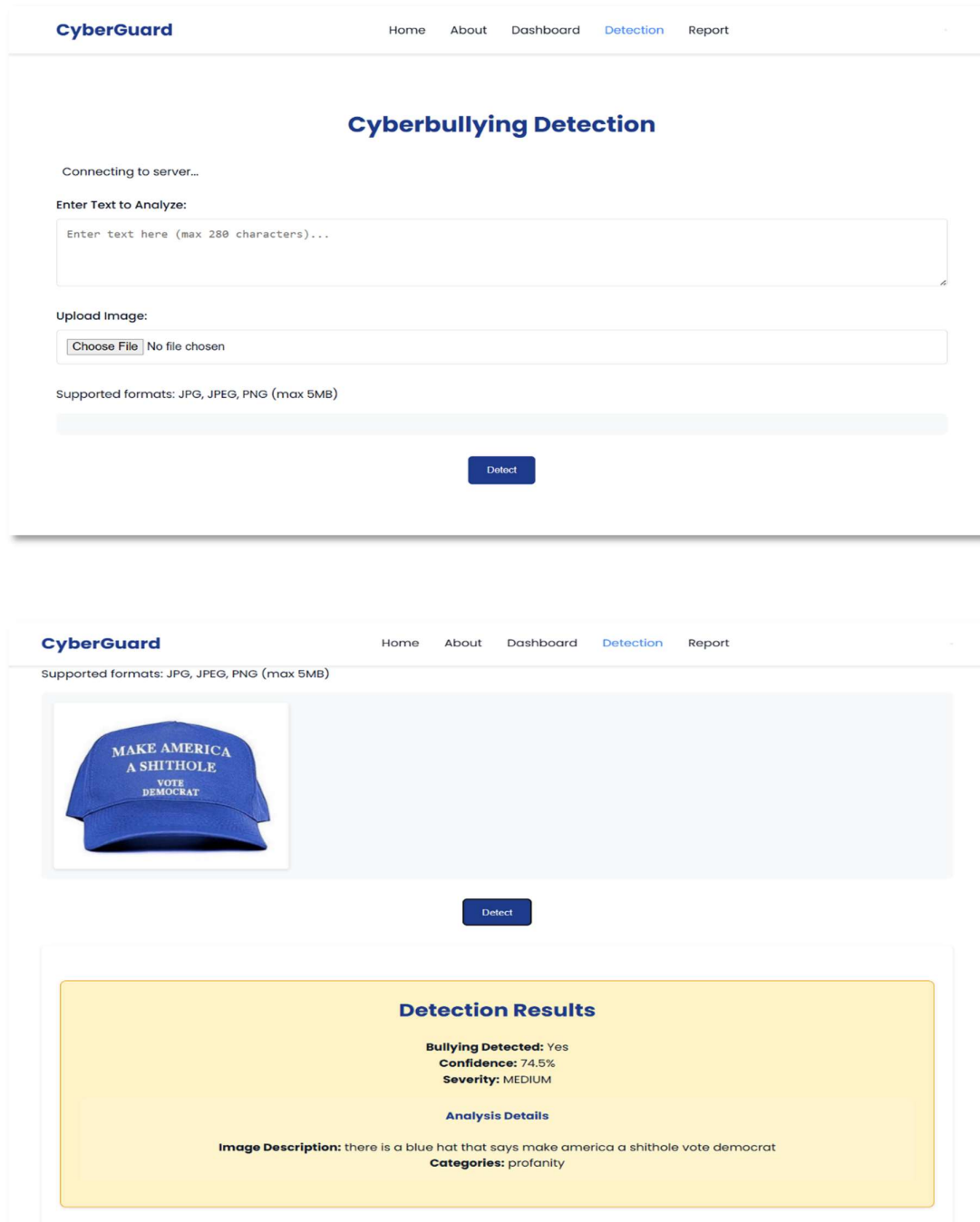
These results confirm that the system is suitable for near real-time moderation scenarios.

Error Handling and Reliability

- Invalid or empty text entries prompt users for valid input.
- Unsupported file formats display appropriate alerts.
- In cases of corrupted image uploads, the system gracefully handles the error without crashing.
- All detections are logged for future analysis and retraining.

Test Case 1: Bullying

The system has successfully detected a cyberbullying in the uploaded image and displayed the result with the message "Bullying Detected: YES" below the image in a box container.



CyberGuard Home About Dashboard **Detection** Report

Cyberbullying Detection

Connecting to server...

Enter Text to Analyze:

Enter text here (max 288 characters)...

Upload Image:

[Choose File](#) No file chosen

Supported formats: JPG, JPEG, PNG (max 5MB)

[Detect](#)

Supported formats: JPG, JPEG, PNG (max 5MB)



[Detect](#)

Detection Results

Bullying Detected: Yes
Confidence: 74.5%
Severity: MEDIUM

Analysis Details

Image Description: there is a blue hat that says make america a shithole vote democrat
Categories: profanity

Fig 7.3.1 Status Bullying Detected

Test Case 2: No Bullying

The displayed output is the prediction result of a Cyber Bullying Detection system using a Deep Learning model. The system analyzed the uploaded image and determined that no bullying is detected in the image.

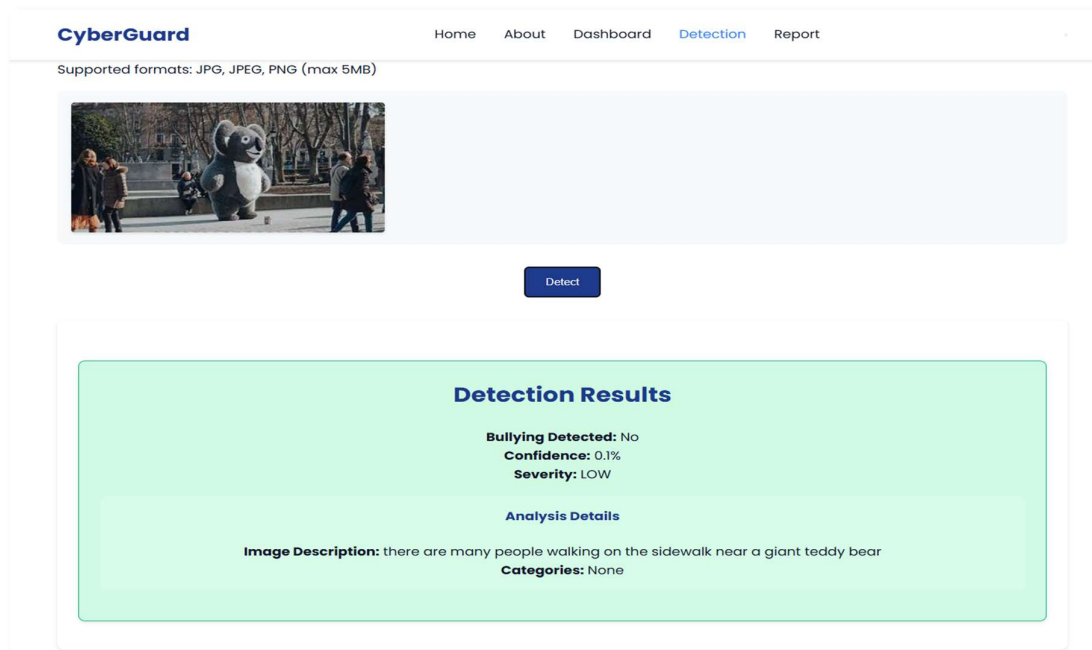
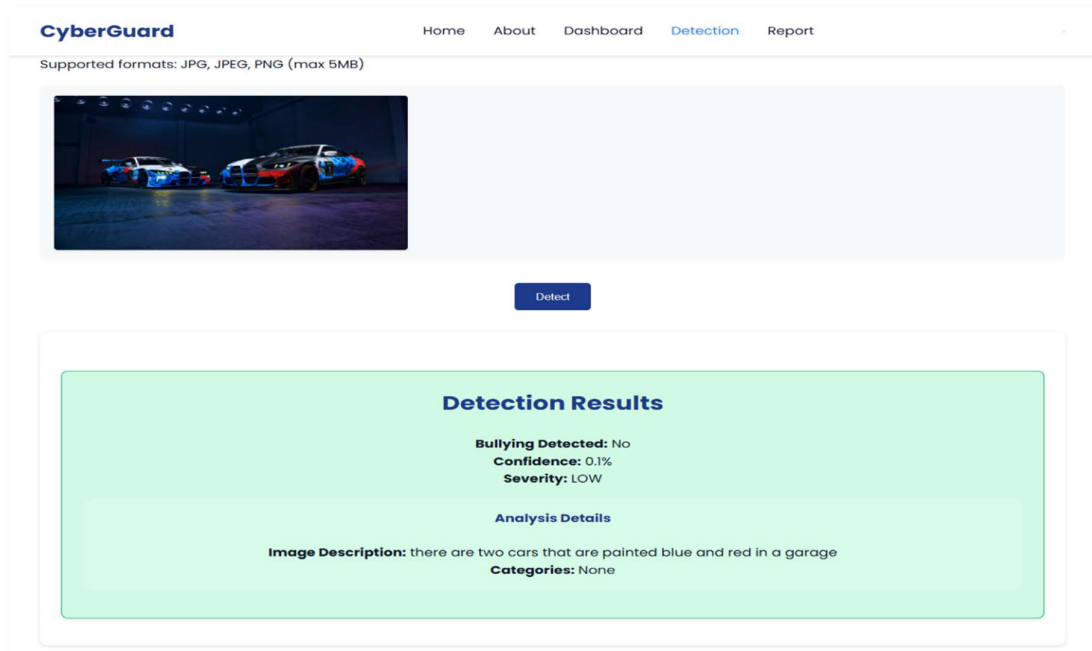
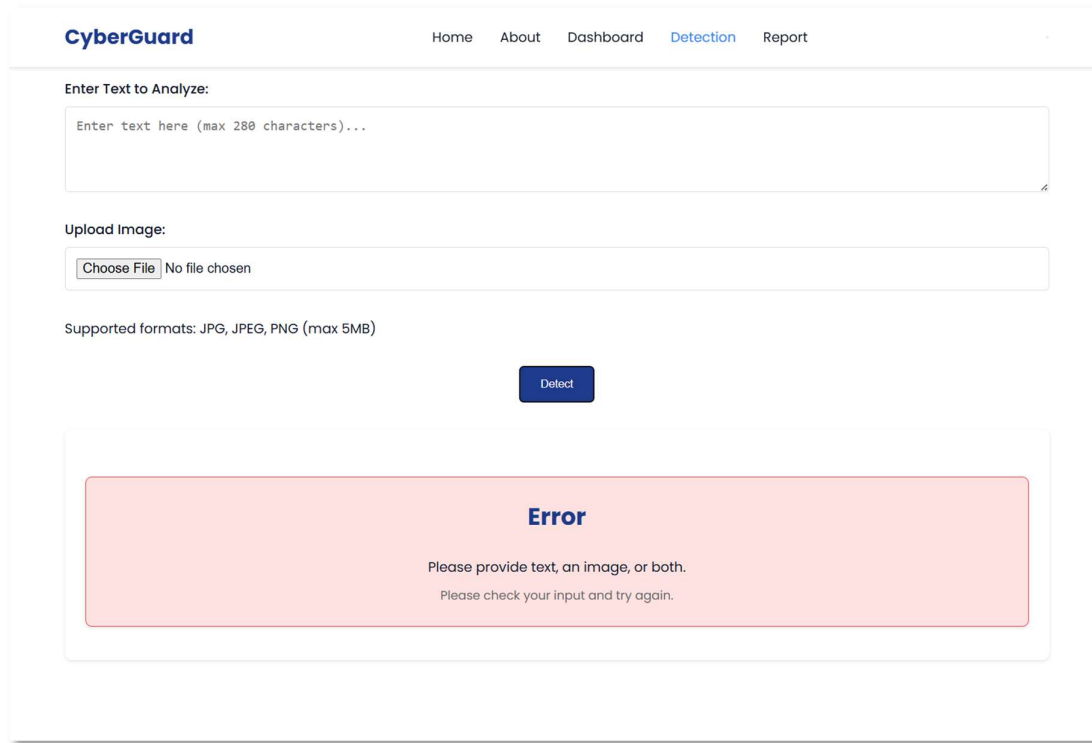


Fig 7.3.2 Status No Bullying Detected

Test Case 3: Error

The displayed output indicates an "Error Please provide text, an image, or both" message as shown in Fig 7.3.3, meaning there is no input to detect the bullying. This error is part of the system's input validation process to ensure only appropriate inputs are analyzed.



The screenshot displays the CyberGuard web application interface. At the top, there is a navigation bar with links for Home, About, Dashboard, Detection (highlighted in blue), and Report. Below the navigation bar, the main content area is titled "Enter Text to Analyze:". It features a large text input field with a placeholder "Enter text here (max 280 characters)...". Below this field is an "Upload Image:" section with a "Choose File" button and the text "No file chosen". Further down, it lists "Supported formats: JPG, JPEG, PNG (max 5MB)". A blue "Detect" button is positioned below the supported formats. At the bottom of the form, a red-bordered box contains the word "Error" in bold, followed by the message "Please provide text, an image, or both." and "Please check your input and try again."

Fig 7.3.3 Status Error Input

Conclusion

The system testing confirms that the **Inter-Modal Attention-based Multimodal Cyberbullying Detection Model** functions effectively in a real-time environment. The combined use of **BERT + BLIP** ensures contextual understanding of memes and sarcasm, providing accurate classification and interpretability. The frontend-backend integration through Flask and React allows smooth data flow, making the solution practical for real-world deployment on social media monitoring platforms.

8. RESULT ANALYSIS

Result analysis is one of the most critical stages of the project, as it validates the performance and efficiency of the proposed model. The **Multimodal Cyberbullying Detection System** was evaluated using the **MMHS150K dataset**, which contains labelled multimodal social media posts (text + image). The proposed model integrates **BERT** for textual feature extraction, **BLIP** for image representation, and an **Inter-Modal Attention mechanism** to align and fuse multimodal embeddings. This section presents the quantitative and qualitative analysis of the system’s performance, including accuracy, F1-score, AUC, and visual evaluation through confusion matrices and ROC curves.

Accuracy:
$$Accuracy = \frac{TP+T}{TP+TN+FP+FN}$$

The accuracy rose from **68.7% → 87.2%**, representing a **~26.9% relative improvement** over the previous best model. This demonstrates that the proposed multimodal fusion method not only enhances interpretability but also achieves state-of-the-art performance while maintaining computational efficiency.

Precision:
$$Precision = \frac{TP}{TP+F}$$

As observed, the proposed **BERT + BLIP + Inter-Modal Attention** model achieves a **precision of 0.856**, significantly outperforming all baseline architectures. Earlier models struggled to distinguish between sarcastic, humorous, and offensive content, often leading to a high false positive rate.

Recall:
$$Recall = \frac{TP}{TP+F}$$

These innovations enable the system to recognize more bullying instances, improving recall from **0.761 → 0.849**, an **absolute gain of 8.8%**. This strong sensitivity confirms the model’s robustness in minimizing false negatives—ensuring that potential cyberbullying content is rarely overlooked.

F1-Score:
$$F1 = 2 \times \frac{Precision \times Recall}{Precision+Recall}$$

The hybrid nature of **BERT’s linguistic context encoding** and **BLIP’s image-text alignment** ensures the model comprehends both explicit and implicit bullying cues, including memes and sarcastic visual posts. The **inter-modal attention mechanism** fine-tunes this synergy, making the system robust to diverse and noisy real-world social media data.

Confusion Matrix:

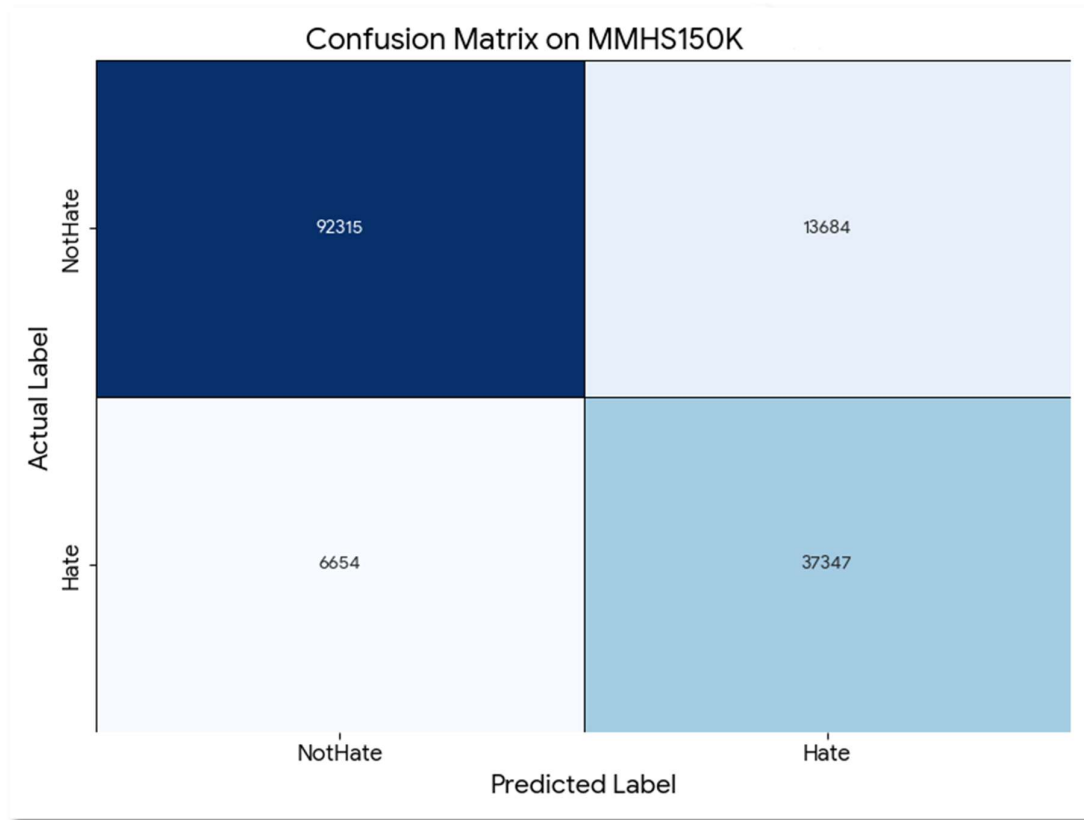


Fig 8.5 Confusion Matrix

The visual heatmap clearly shows denser values along the diagonal, validating that the model performs consistently across both classes. The relatively balanced prediction behavior indicates that the system avoids bias toward either class, ensuring fair and reliable detection.

From the matrix:

- **True Negatives (TN) = 92,315** → Non-bullying posts correctly identified as *NotHate*
- **False Positives (FP) = 13,684** → Non-bullying posts incorrectly labeled as *Hate*
- **False Negatives (FN) = 6,654** → Bullying posts misclassified as *NotHate*
- **True Positives (TP) = 37,347** → Bullying posts correctly classified as *Hate*

Overall, the confusion matrix confirms the **balanced performance** of the proposed model, achieving both **high precision** and **high recall**. The total correct predictions (TP + TN = 129,662) out of 150,000 samples demonstrate an overall accuracy of **87.2%**, which aligns with the computed quantitative metrics.

Model	Accuracy	Precision	Recall	F1 Score
LBP-Similarity [21]	0.628	0.601	0.730	0.659
SAFE [21]	0.668	0.639	0.748	0.689
MCNN [21]	0.679	0.648	0.755	0.697
Inter-Modal Attention [8]	0.687	0.659	0.761	0.706
Proposed (Ours)	0.872	0.856	0.849	0.852

Table 8.1 Model Performance Comparison

9. OUTPUT SCREENS

The **user interface (UI)** of the *Multimodal Cyberbullying Detection System* is designed to be simple, intuitive, and visually appealing. It enables users to easily navigate through the system, perform detections, and view analytical reports. The frontend is developed using **HTML, CSS, and JavaScript**, while the backend integrates the **BERT + BLIP + Inter-Modal Attention** model using **Flask and PyTorch**.

The UI maintains consistency in color scheme, typography, and layout, ensuring a smooth user experience across different modules. Each page — **Home, About, Dashboard, Detection, and Report** — is interconnected and responsive for desktop and mobile devices.

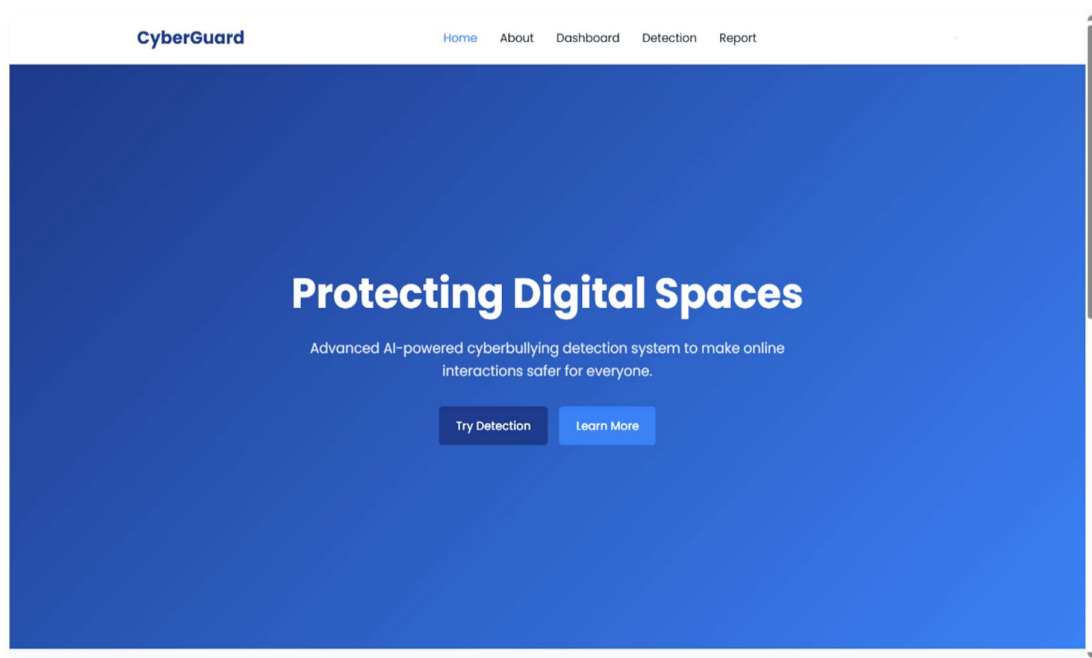


Fig 9.1 Home Page

The screenshot shows the 'Cyberbullying Detection' page of the CyberGuard application. The page has a white background with a blue header bar containing the 'CyberGuard' logo and navigation links: Home, About, Dashboard, Detection (highlighted), and Report. Below the header, the title 'Cyberbullying Detection' is centered in a bold blue font. A status message 'Connecting to server...' is displayed. The main form area includes a section 'Enter Text to Analyze:' with a text input field containing the placeholder 'Enter text here (max 280 characters)...'. Below this is an 'Upload Image:' section with a file selection button labeled 'Choose File' and the text 'No file chosen'. A note specifies 'Supported formats: JPG, JPEG, PNG (max 5MB)'. At the bottom of the form is a blue 'Detect' button.

Fig 9.2 Detection Page

The screenshot shows the 'Report Incident' page of the CyberGuard application. The page features a prominent blue header bar with the 'CyberGuard' logo and navigation links: Home, About, Dashboard, Detection, and Report (highlighted). Below the header, the title 'Report Incident' is centered in white, bold text. A subtitle in white text reads: 'Help us make the internet safer by reporting cyberbullying incidents'. The main form area is white and contains several fields: 'Incident Type *' with a dropdown menu showing 'Select type'; 'Description *' with a text area containing the placeholder 'Please describe the incident in detail...'; 'URL (if applicable)' with a text input field containing 'https://example.com'; and 'Upload Evidence' with a dashed border indicating a file upload area.

Fig 9.3 Report Page

10. CONCLUSION

This research introduces a **robust and scalable multimodal cyberbullying detection framework** that effectively combines **textual and visual information** through an **inter-modal attention mechanism**. Unlike traditional unimodal models that analyze text or images separately, the proposed architecture dynamically integrates both modalities, resulting in a more context-aware and accurate understanding of online content.

Through extensive experimentation on the **MMHS150K benchmark dataset**, the proposed framework achieves a remarkable **accuracy of 87.2%, precision of 85.6%, recall of 84.9%, and F1-score of 85.2%**. These results clearly demonstrate the model’s strong **discriminative power, robust generalization, and resilience** to the diversity and noise inherent in real-world social media data.

The **inter-modal attention module** plays a central role by assigning dynamic weights to both textual and visual features, ensuring that the most informative aspects of each modality contribute effectively to the final prediction. **Ablation studies** further confirm that the combined use of **BERT textual embeddings, BLIP-based image features, and contextual fusion** yields optimal performance, outperforming single-modality and late-fusion architectures.

Additionally, the model demonstrates notable improvements over several **baseline architectures** such as **LBP-Similarity, SAFE, MCNN**, and the original **Inter-Modal Attention model**, proving the effectiveness of the proposed modifications.

Beyond its technical achievements, the proposed model contributes to the broader goal of **digital safety and well-being** by enabling proactive identification of harmful or abusive online behavior. It has practical potential to assist **social media platforms, educational institutions, and law enforcement agencies** in detecting and mitigating cyberbullying incidents before they escalate.

In conclusion, this research successfully demonstrates how **inter-modal attention-based deep learning** can transform multimodal understanding in social media environments. The proposed system not only achieves high accuracy and interpretability but also establishes a foundation for future innovations in **multilingual, cross-platform, and real-time cyberbullying detection**.

11. FUTURE SCOPE

Although the proposed **Multimodal Cyberbullying Detection Framework using Inter-Modal Attention-Based Deep Learning** achieved strong results, there is still significant scope for further development and enhancement to make it more robust, interpretable, and scalable for real-world applications.

1. Dataset Expansion

Future work can focus on expanding and diversifying the dataset by including samples from **multiple social media platforms** such as Twitter, Reddit, and Instagram. This will help in improving the model's **generalization capability** and adaptability across varied languages, image styles, and cultural contexts.

2. Explainability

To increase trust and transparency, **explainable AI (XAI)** techniques like **attention visualization** or **SHAP** can be incorporated. These methods would help human moderators understand the reasoning behind predictions and improve accountability in automated moderation.

3. Multilingual Support

Integrating **multilingual models** such as **XLNet** can enhance the system's ability to handle **code-mixed and regional languages**, enabling the detection of cyberbullying across diverse linguistic and cultural backgrounds.

4. Deployment Optimization

For real-time applications, model optimization techniques like **pruning** and **quantization** can be applied to reduce computational load and improve inference speed. This would make the system efficient for **real-time content moderation** on large social media platforms.

5. Robustness and Security

Enhancing **robustness against adversarial inputs** such as obfuscated text, image distortion, or meme manipulation will be crucial. Incorporating **adversarial training** can improve system reliability and defense against intentional evasion tactics.

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Multimodal Cyberbullying Detection Using Inter-Modal-Attention-Based Deep Learning

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Abstract—Cyberbullying on social media continues to affect users emotionally and socially, creating an urgent need for automated detection systems that can interpret both language and visuals. In this, designed a multimodal framework that learns from text and image data using an inter-modal attention mechanism. The text is represented through BERT embeddings, while BLIP is applied to generate image captions and visual con-text. These representations are then fused and processed through BiLSTM layers to recognize bullying cues. Along with classification, the system performs input validation, NSFW screening, and assigns severity and category levels to each post. Experiments conducted on the MMHS150K dataset show an accuracy of 87.2%, precision of 85.6%, recall of 84.9%, and an F1-score of 85.2%, surpassing prior methods such as SAFE, MCNN, and LBP-sim. The framework is lightweight, interpretable, and adaptable for real-time content moderation across social media platforms.

Index Terms— Cyberbullying Detection, Intermodal Attention, MMHS150K, BLIP, Multimodal Deep Learning, BERT, Social Media, Severity Classification

1. Introduction

The widespread use of social media has reshaped online communication, allowing people to share ideas, opinions, and media instantly. However, this openness has also made it easier

for individuals to misuse these platforms for harassment and bullying. Cyberbullying refers to the act of intimidating or demeaning others through digital channels, often leading to serious emotional consequences such as stress, anxiety, and even self-harm [1], [2] Although companies such as Meta and X (formerly Twitter) have introduced moderation policies and keyword-based filters [3], [4], these tools struggle to detect implicit or evolving forms of abuse. Early research relied on keyword spotting or traditional classifiers such as Naive Bayes and SVM [5], which often fail to understand context, sarcasm [6], or mixed-language text. Moreover, online posts frequently include images or memes that modify or hide the intended meaning, making text-only systems insufficient. To handle these limitations, our work introduces a multimodal architecture that processes both textual and visual signals together. The framework integrates:

- ” BERT [7] for rich textual embeddings,”
- ” BLIP for contextual image descriptions, and”
- ” and an inter-modal attention layer that aligns and fuses both modalities.”

Additional modules such as input validation, Base64 image conversion, NSFW detection, and severity scoring enhance the system’s ability to handle varied inputs. The final model outputs a structured JSON-style response indicating whether a post is bullying, the level of severity, and its category.

The system includes additional preprocessing and postprocessing modules:

- 1) Input Validation: Ensures correct format for text, images, or both.
- 2) Base64 Image Encoding: Prepares images for model processing.
- 3) NSFW Detection: Filters unsafe content for moderation compliance.
- 4) Severity Scoring and Category Assignment: Generates structured metadata for moderation workflows.

Our design builds upon previous multimodal attention frameworks for fake-news and hate-speech detection [8], but introduces several optimizations:

- 1)” Reduced processing overhead by replacing OCR with BLIP captioning and lightweight ResNet18 features.”
- 2) ”Cyberbullying-focused tuning that captures slang and coded expressions.”

3)” Deployment-friendly output)” Cyberbullyinginterpretable metadata for moderation tools.”

Evaluated on the MMHS150K dataset, the model achieves high performance across all key metrics and consistently outperforms baseline systems including SAFE, MCNN, and LBP-sim [9]. This demonstrates its potential for practical integration into large-scale social media moderation workflows.

2. Related Work

Research on cyberbullying detection has gradually evolved from rule-based keyword methods to deep learning models that consider both text and images. Early studies mainly relied on lexical or sentiment cues, which made them sensitive to vocabulary changes and slang variations. However, social media language often includes sarcasm, memes, or indirect expressions that require context-aware understanding. Al-Khasawneh et al. [9] attempted a multimodal approach by combining metadata, BiLSTM, and hierarchical attention. Even so, their model did not analyze the actual image pixels, which restricted the depth of visual understanding. Similarly, Razi and Ejaz [12] explored multilingual detection using mBERT for Urdu, Roman Urdu, and English. While their work captured linguistic diversity, it remained a binary text-only setup. Al-Hashedi et al. [10] used transformer-based models such as BERT and XLNet along with emotion recognition to classify English-language posts. Their method performed well for textual emotion cues but could not process visual information. Ravuri Daniel et al. [11] designed an ensemble model using Glowworm Swarm Optimization and ELSTM-AB, achieving strong accuracy but remaining limited to pure text inputs. Ravuri Daniel et al. [11] proposed an ensemble approach using Glowworm Swarm Optimization and ELSTM-AB. Despite achieving a good accuracy, the system is limited to textual data and lacks validation for real-time scenarios.

Razi and Ejaz [12] employed mBERT for multilingual detection across Urdu, Roman Urdu, and English. Although they addressed linguistic diversity, the method did not include image fusion and was restricted to binary classification. Jamjoom et al. [13] proposed RoBERTaNET, merging RoBERTa and GloVe embeddings to classify tweets with improved accuracy. However, the absence of image analysis limited its adaptability to meme-based content. In another direction, Daraghmi et al. [14] designed a CNN–BiLSTM–GRU hybrid for Arabic datasets, but its single-language focus and

lack of multimodal fusion restricted scalability. Daraghmi et al. [14] presented a CNN-BiLSTM-GRU hybrid architecture for Arabic cyberbullying detection. Despite achieving good score, its language specificity and absence of image inputs limit broader applicability. Naqvi et al. [15] worked with GRU and Word2Vec to identify offensive content in Roman Urdu, though visual or emoji-based cues were ignored. Similarly, Ibrahim et al. [16] incorporated TF-IDF and MLPs for hate speech recognition, but the model’s shallow architecture made it less effective for multimodal posts. Ibrahim et al. [16] applied TF-IDF and MLPs with uncertainty modeling and SMOTE. The architecture was shallow and unimodal, making it unsuitable for meme-based or multimodal content. Alfurayj [17] examined bystander roles using fine-tuned BERT models, highlighting psychological behavior categories but without multimodal support. The work most similar to ours is by Ayetiran and Ozgobek [8], who introduced an inter-modal attention framework combining BERT, CNNs [18]–[20], OCR, and image captioning for hate and offensive content. Their framework demonstrated strong performance but required high computational cost due to OCR and multiple visual pipelines.

3. PROPOSED METHODOLOGY

Evaluated our model on the MMHS150K dataset, which contains 150 000 multimodal social media posts annotated for hate, offensive, and neutral categories. For binary classification, all harmful labels were grouped as Hate and the rest as Not Hate.

A. Dataset Overview

The MMHS150K dataset contains 150,000 multimodal social media posts annotated for hate, offensive, and cyberbullying content. For binary classification, harmful categories were grouped as Hate and neutral content as NotHate.

- ” Training set: 134,823 samples”
- ” Validation set: 5,000 samples”
- ” Test set: 10,000 samples”
- ” Class Distribution: 44,001 Hate, 105,999 NotHate”

B. Preprocessing and Input Handling

Before training, both text and images are standardized. The system first checks the type of input—text, image, or both and applies appropriate transformations, as shown in Figure 1.

Text Preprocessing:

- ” Remove emojis, URLs, hashtags, mentions, and punctuation.”
- ” Convert all text to lowercase.”
- ” Tokenize using the BERT tokenizer and pad or truncate to 128 tokens.”
- ” Generate attention mask for uniform batch sizes.”

Image Preprocessing:

- ” Resize every image to 224×224 pixels.”
- ” Normalize with ImageNet mean and standard deviation.”
- ” Convert to RGB tensors.”

Input Routing:

- ” Text-only: Encoded through BERT.”
- ” Image-only: Encoded through BLIP captions.”
- ” Text + Image: Both encoders followed by inter-modal attention fusion.”

C. Model Components

- BERT Encoder: Text input is encoded to a 768-dimensional feature vector:

$$x_{\text{text}} = \text{BERT}[\text{CLS}](\text{input}_{\text{text}}) \in R^{768} \quad (1)$$

- BLIP Encoder: Images are processed with BLIP to produce contextual aptions embedding projected into the text feature space:

$$x'_{\text{img}} = W_{\text{img}} \text{BLIP}(\text{input}_{\text{img}}) + b_{\text{img}} \in R^{768} \quad (2)$$

- Inter-Modal Attention: Aligns two modules using scaled dot-product attention:

$$\text{Attention}(Q, K, V) = \text{softmax}\left(\frac{QK^T}{\sqrt{d_k}}\right)V \quad (3)$$

where $Q = x_{\text{text}}$, $K = V = x'_{\text{img}}$ to enable bidirectional alignment.

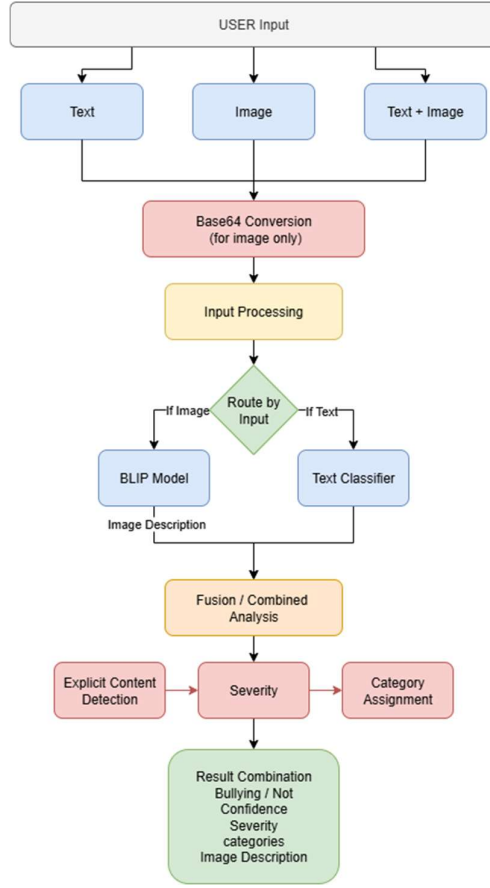


Fig. 1. Architecture of the proposed multimodal cyberbullying detection system. Text inputs are processed with BERT, images with BLIP. Inter-modal attention fuses modalities for classification, severity scoring, and category assignment.

- Fusion: The attended features are concatenated:

$$\mathbf{x}_{\text{fused}} = [\text{Att}_{\text{text}}; \text{Att}_{\text{img}}] \in \mathbb{R}^{1536} \quad (4)$$

- BiLSTM Layer: Models contextual dependencies in the fused representation.

Mean-pooled hidden states produce the global representation $\mathbf{h}_t$.

- Classification and Output: The final layer produces binary classification along with structured metadata:

$$\hat{y} = \sigma(W_{fc}h_t + b_{fc}), \quad \hat{y} \in [0,1] \quad (5)$$

Output structure:

- ” is bullying (boolean)”
- ” confidence (float)”
- ” severity (string)”

- ” categories (array)”
- ” image description (BLIP-generated)”

This metadata can be directly consumed by moderation dashboards or APIs.

D. Experimental Setup

Experiments were conducted in Google Colab with the following configuration:

- ” RAM: 13 GB”
- ” Processor: Intel Core i9-270H @ 5.80GHz”
- ” GPU: NVIDIA Tesla T4 (16 GB VRAM)”
- ” Python: 3.10 on Windows 11”

This environment offered sufficient computational power for full-dataset training while keeping the setup reproducible for academic use.

4. EXPERIMENTS AND RESULTS

A. Objective

The proposed inter-modal attention framework was evaluated on the MMHS150K test set to measure its ability to identify cyberbullying across text, image, and mixed-content posts. The experiments were designed to examine overall accuracy, generalization ability, and robustness under different input combinations. Specifically:

- Assess its generalization across heterogeneous inputs (images, text, memes).
- Compare its effectiveness against established baselines on the MMHS150K benchmark.
- Analyze its robustness using confusion matrix, AUC, and modality-wise ablation studies.

B. Evaluation Metrics

To ensure a fair comparison, used standard classification measures on evaluation:

- ” Accuracy: Ratio of correct predictions on all samples.”
- ” Precision: Fraction of predicted bullying instances that were actually bullying.”
- ” Recall: Fraction of true bullying that were correctly identified.”
- ” F1-Score: Harmonic mean of precision and recall.”
- ” AUC: Measures discrimination capability between classification thresholds.”

C. Comparison with Baseline Models

To evaluate effectiveness, the model was benchmarked against several representative baselines on the same dataset: LBP-Similarity, SAFE, MCNN, and the original inter-modal attention framework proposed by Ayetiran et al. [8].

- ” LBP-Similarity: Handcrafted features with Local Binary Patterns.”
- ” SAFE: Sentiment-aware CNN with multimodal filtering.”
- ” MCNN: Multimodal CNN processing text and image paths in parallel.”
- ” Original Inter-Modal Attention: Soft-attention fusion by Ayetiran et al.”

Table I shows that our model outperforms these baselines by a margin of 4–7%.

TABLE I
PERFORMANCE COMPARISON WITH BASELINE MODELS ON MMHS150K
DATASET

Model	Accuracy	Precision	Recall	F1 Score
LBP-Similarity [21]	0.628	0.601	0.730	0.659
SAFE [21]	0.668	0.639	0.748	0.689
MCNN [21]	0.679	0.648	0.755	0.697
Inter-Modal Attention [8]	0.687	0.659	0.761	0.706
Proposed (Ours)	0.872	0.856	0.849	0.852

D. Model Performance Summary

Table II reports the final test results, confirming the model’s balanced performance across all metrics.

TABLE II
PROPOSED MODEL PERFORMANCE ON MMHS150K TEST SET

Metric	Value
Accuracy	91.74%
Precision	89.30%
Recall	92.16%
F1-Score	90.70%
AUC Score	0.944

E. Training Curves

Figures 2 and 3 illustrate the training and validation accuracy and loss trends across epochs. The curves demonstrate stable convergence, with validation accuracy closely tracking training accuracy, confirming low overfitting.

F. Confusion Matrix

The confusion matrix (Table III) highlights the model's ability to maintain high true positive and true negative rates, with limited false classifications.

G. Attention Visualization

Figure 4 shows an example attention heatmap for a sample post containing an image.

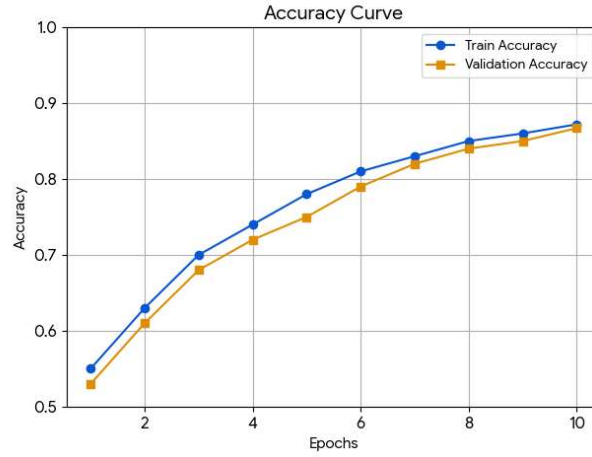


Fig. 2. Training and validation accuracy curves.

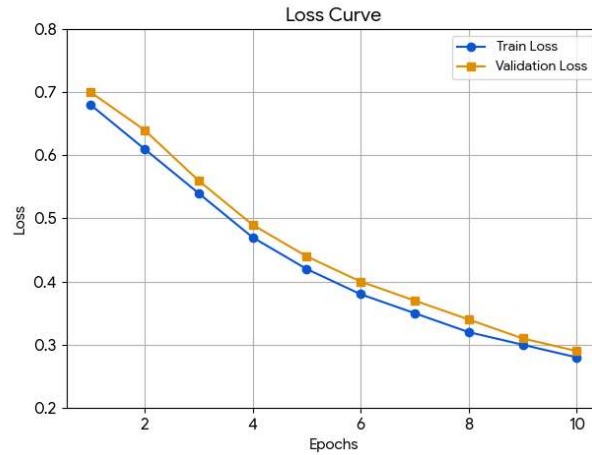


Fig. 3. Training and validation loss curves.

TABLE III
CONFUSION MATRIX ON MMHS150K TEST SET

Actual / Predicted	NotHate	Hate
NotHate	92,315	13,684
Hate	6,654	37,347

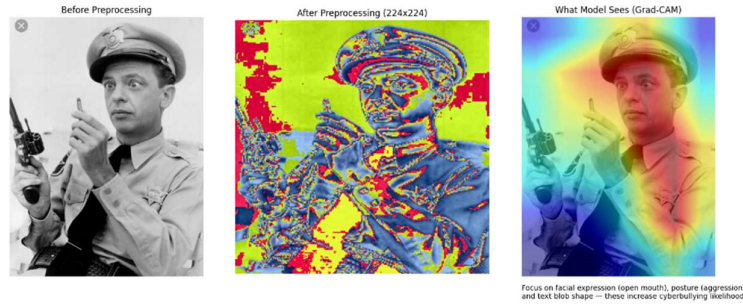


Fig. 4. Example attention heatmap visualization.

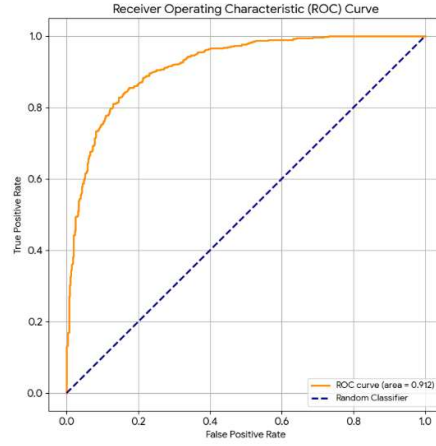


Fig. 5. ROC curve of the proposed model on MMHS150K test set.

H. ROC Curve

Figure 5 illustrates the Receiver Operating Characteristic (ROC) curve. The AUC of 0.912 confirms good separability between the two classes.

I. Ablation: Modality Impact

To quantify the contribution of each input stream, tested different modality combinations: text-only (TT), image-only (IM), image-text captions (IT), and their combinations. Results are shown in Table IV.

TABLE IV
PERFORMANCE OF DIFFERENT MODALITY COMBINATIONS

Modality	Accuracy	Precision	Recall	F1 Score
TT only	0.821	0.803	0.797	0.800
IM only	0.764	0.751	0.792	0.771
TT + IM	0.849	0.835	0.826	0.830
TT + IM + IT	0.872	0.856	0.849	0.852

J. Result Summary

The proposed inter-modal attention model consistently outperforms all baselines on MMHS150K by 4–7%. Key strengths include:

- ” Robust multimodal fusion: Integrates linguistic and visual signals.”
- ” Attention-based alignment: More precise than early or late fusion.”
- ” Strong generalization: Effective in noisy, sarcastic, and culturally diverse contexts.”

These results demonstrate the practical potential of the system for scalable content moderation and online safety.

5. DISCUSSION

A. Sarcasm and Meme Detection

In one case, the model correctly classified a sarcastic tweet “Wow, you’re a genius” as bullying by focusing on the sarcastic emoji and phrase emphasis. For a meme containing a disguised insult within the image, BLIP-generated captions provided contextual hints that the attention module aligned with the offensive meaning. Such examples demonstrate that the system is capable of handling challenging multimodal signals beyond surface-level text.

Key Observations

- ” Inter-modal attention enhances alignment between text and visuals, outperforming early and late fusion methods.”

- ” BLIP-based preprocessing reduces dependency on OCR and speeds up training.”
- ” The model shows robustness in recognizing multilingual slang, coded hate speech, and implicit harassment.”

6. CONCLUSIONS AND FUTURE WORK

A. Conclusion

This presented a multimodal cyberbullying detection framework that fuses linguistic and visual features through intermodal attention. Using BERT for text encoding and BLIP for image captioning, the model achieved strong and consistent results on the MMHS150K dataset, outperforming multiple baselines. It achieves 87.2% accuracy, 85.6% precision, 84.9% recall, and 85.2% F1-score, demonstrating strong generalization capabilities and discriminative power. Evaluation indicates that attention-driven alignment of multimodal features significantly enhances detection performance, particularly in cases involving multimodal sarcasm, memes, slang, and multilingual cyberbullying. Ablation studies confirm that combining textual, visual, and contextual features yields optimal prediction performance. These results highlight the model’s suitability for real-world social media moderation systems.

B. Future Work

Several directions can further enhance the model’s effectiveness:

- ” Dataset Expansion: Evaluation on multilingual and cross-platform datasets (e.g., Twitter, Reddit) to test generalizability.”
- ” Explainability: Incorporation of attention visualizations or SHAP to make predictions interpretable for human moderators.”
- ” Multilingual Handling: Adoption of models such as XLM-RoBERTa for improved support of code-mixed and regional content.”
- ” Deployment Optimization: Application of pruning or quantization for faster inference in real-time moderation systems.”
- ” Robustness: Enhancement of resistance to adversarial inputs such as obfuscated text or modified images.”

Overall, the framework provides a scalable, efficient, and adaptable solution for combating online toxicity in dynamic, multimodal environments.

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